Southeast Conservation Blueprint Summary

for Alabama

Created 10/16/2026

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The Southeast Conservation Blueprint 2026

Southeast Conservation Adaptation Strategy

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About the Southeast Blueprint

The Southeast Conservation Blueprint is the primary product of the Southeast Conservation Adaptation Strategy (SECAS). It is a living, spatial plan to achieve the SECAS vision of a connected network of lands and waters across the Southeast and Caribbean. The Blueprint is regularly updated to incorporate new data, partner input, and information about on-the-ground conditions.

The Blueprint identifies priority areas based on a suite of natural and cultural resource indicators representing terrestrial, freshwater, and marine ecosystems. A connectivity analysis identifies corridors that link coastal and inland areas and span climate gradients.

For more information:

- Visit the Blueprint webpage
- Review the Blueprint 2026 Development Process
- View and download the Blueprint data and make maps on the Blueprint page of the SECAS Atlas

We're here to help!

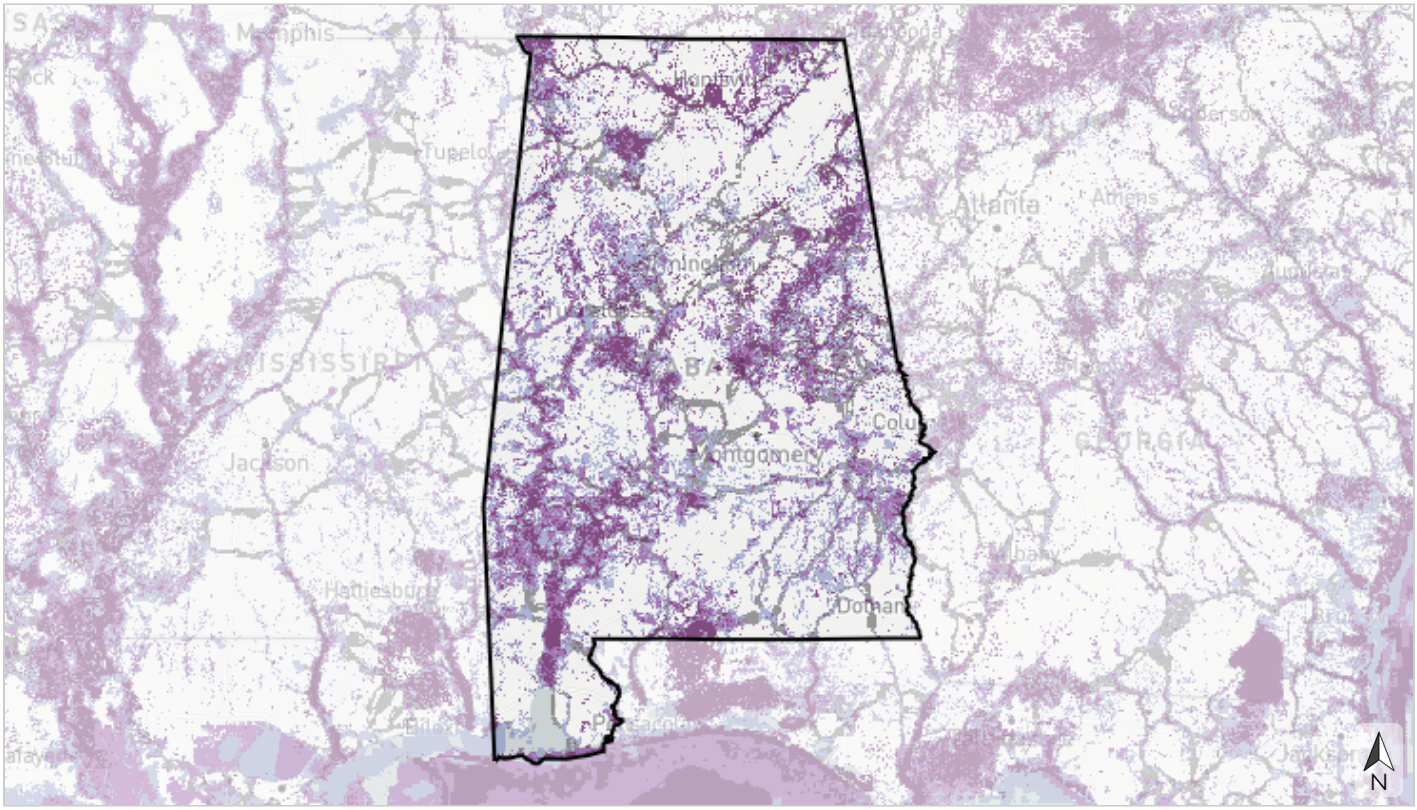
- Do you have a question about the Blueprint?
- Would you like help using the Blueprint to support a proposal or inform a decision?
- Do you have a suggestion on how to improve the Blueprint? The Blueprint and its inputs are regularly revised based on input from people like you.
- Do you have feedback on how to improve the Blueprint Explorer interface?

If you need help or have questions, contact Southeast Blueprint staff by reaching out to a member of the user support team.

We're here to support you. We really mean it. It's what we do!

This report was generated by the Southeast Conservation Blueprint Explorer, which was developed by Astute Spruce, LLC in partnership with the U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service under the Southeast Conservation Adaptation Strategy.

Southeast Blueprint Priorities



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Priorities for a connected network of lands and waters

- Highest priority
- High priority
- Medium priority
- Priority connections

Priority Categories

For a connected network of lands and waters

In total, Blueprint priorities and priority connections cover roughly 50% of the Southeast Blueprint geography.

Highest priority

Areas where conservation action would make the biggest impact, based on a suite of natural and cultural resource indicators. This class covers roughly 10% of the Southeast Blueprint geography.

High priority

Areas where conservation action would make a big impact, based on a suite of natural and cultural resource indicators. This class covers roughly 15% of the Southeast Blueprint geography.

Medium priority

Areas where conservation action would make an above-average impact, based on a suite of natural and cultural resource indicators. This class covers roughly 20% of the Southeast Blueprint geography.

Priority connections

Connections between priority areas that cover the shortest distance possible while routing through as much Blueprint priority as possible. This class covers roughly 5% of the Southeast Blueprint geography.

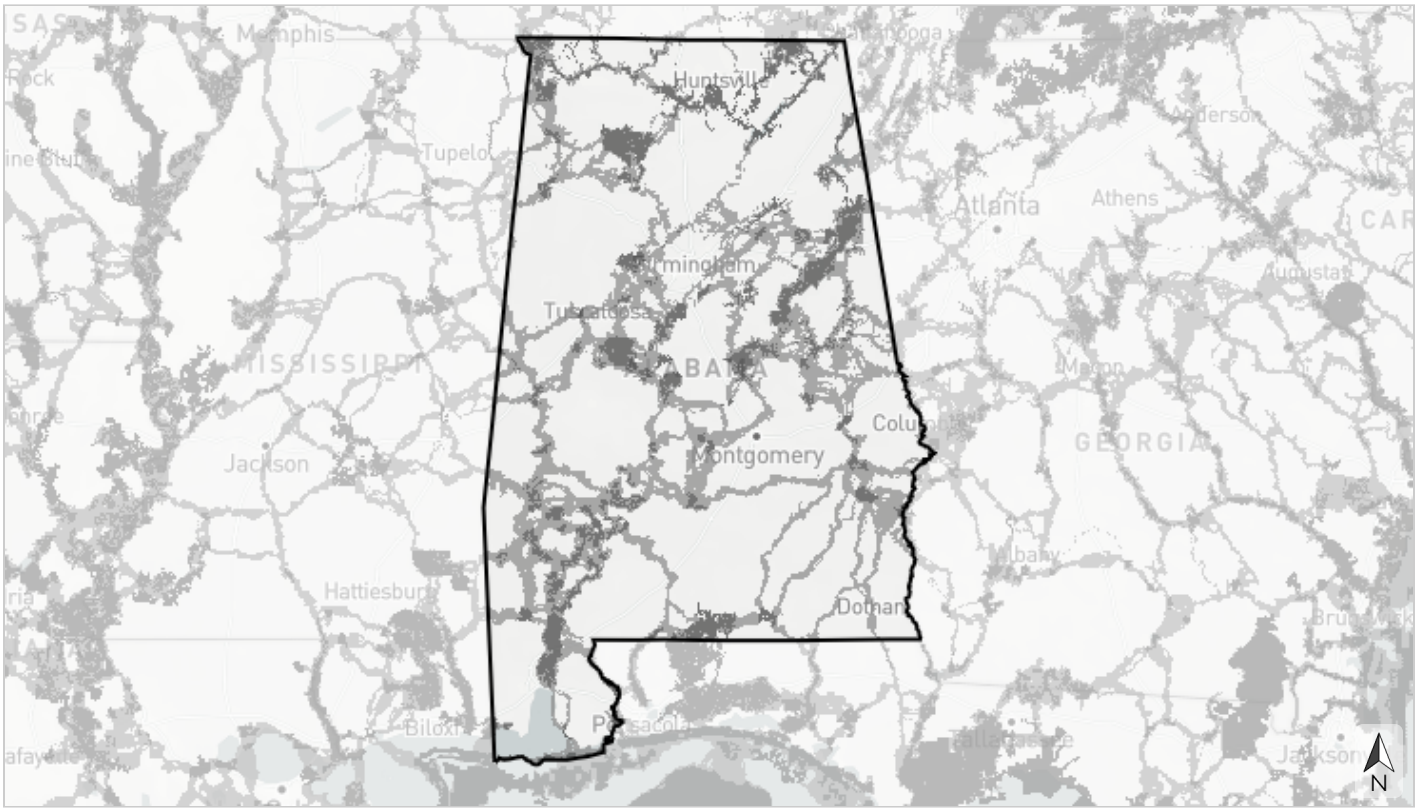
Table 1: Extent of each Blueprint priority category within Alabama.

Priority Category	Acres	Percent of Area
Highest priority	3,234,768	9.6%
High priority	4,961,904	14.8%
Medium priority	6,372,154	19.0%
Priority connections	2,274,531	6.8%
Lower priority	16,705,451	49.8%
Total area	**33,548,808**	**100%**

Hubs and Corridors

The Blueprint uses a least-cost path connectivity analysis to identify corridors that link hubs across the shortest distance possible, while also routing through as much Blueprint priority as possible.

In the continental Southeast, hubs are large patches (~5,000+ acres) of highest priority Blueprint areas and/or protected lands.



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Hubs
Corridors

Table 2: Extent of hubs and corridors within Alabama.

Type	Acres	Percent of Area
Hubs	2,560,886	7.6%
Corridors	7,223,126	21.5%
Not a hub or corridor	23,764,796	70.8%
Total area	**33,548,808**	**100%**

Indicator Summary

Table 3: Terrestrial indicators.

Indicator	Present
East Coastal Plain open pine birds	✓
Fire frequency	✓
Grassland & savanna extent	✓
Grassland & savanna restoration	✓
Greenways & trails	✓
Imperiled amphibians & reptiles	✓
Imperiled mammals	✓
Intact habitat cores	✓
Landscape condition	✓
Mississippi Alluvial Valley forest birds - protection	-
Mississippi Alluvial Valley forest birds - reforestation	-
Potential access to parks	✓
Resilient terrestrial sites	✓
River cane restoration	✓
South Atlantic forest birds	✓
South Atlantic low-urban historic landscapes	✓
Urban park size	✓
West Gulf Coast mottled duck nesting	-

Table 4: Freshwater indicators.

Indicator	Present
Atlantic migratory fish habitat	-
Floodplain inundation	✓
Gulf migratory fish connectivity	✓
Imperiled aquatic species	✓
Lakes & reservoirs	✓
Natural landcover in floodplains	✓
Network complexity	✓
Permeable surface	✓

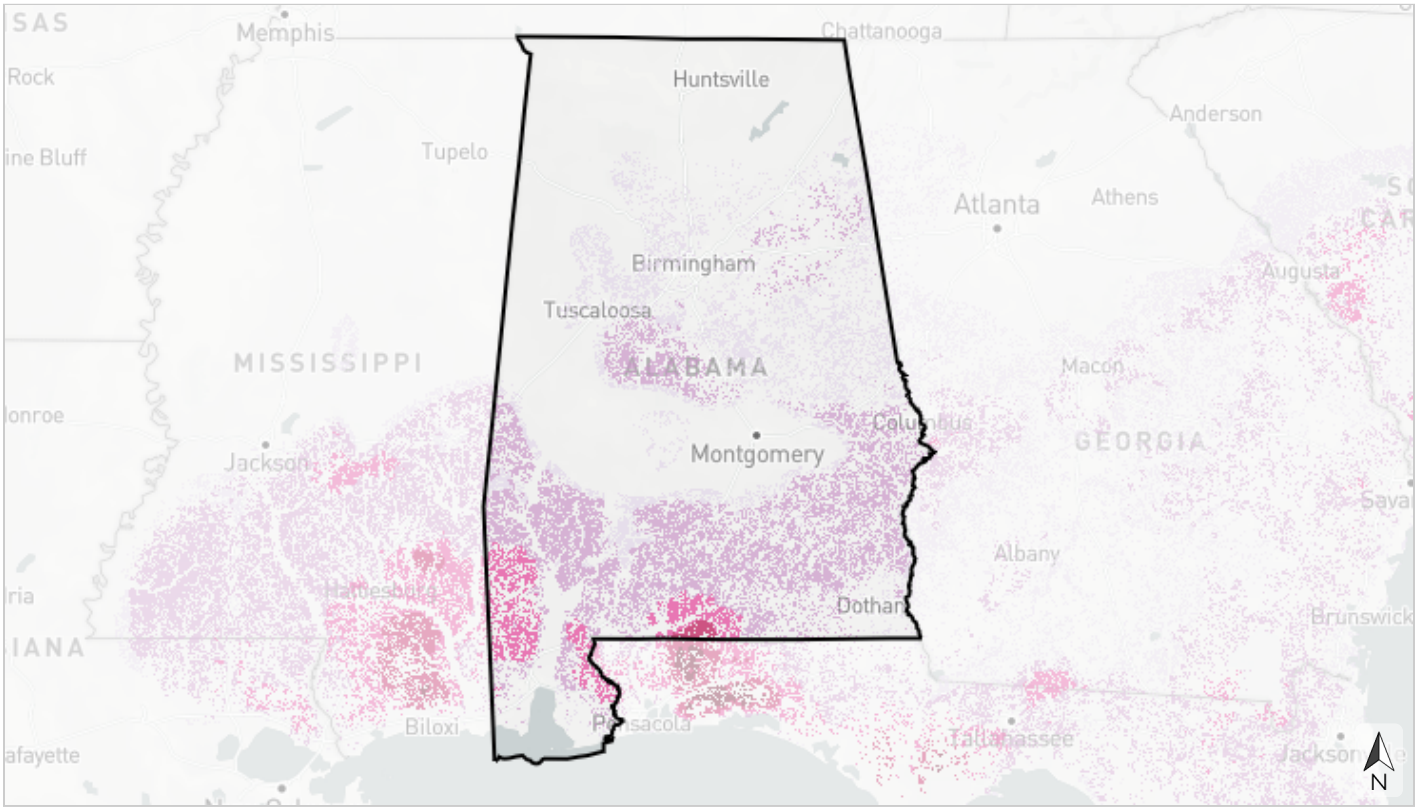
Table 5: Coastal & marine indicators.

Indicator	Present
Atlantic estuarine fish habitat	-
Coastal shoreline condition	✓
Estuarine coastal condition	✓
Gulf coral & hardbottom	✓
Gulf deep-sea coral richness	-
Gulf marine birds	✓
Gulf marine mammals	✓
Gulf sea turtles	✓
Island habitat	✓
Marine highly migratory fish	-
Resilient coastal sites	✓
Seagrass	✓
South Atlantic maritime forest	-
Stable coastal wetlands	✓

Terrestrial

East Coastal Plain open pine birds

This indicator identifies areas within the historical longleaf pine range east of the Mississippi River where creating or maintaining open pine habitat would most benefit six focal species of birds (Bachman's sparrow, red-cockaded woodpecker, Henslow's sparrow, red-headed woodpecker, Northern bobwhite, brown-headed nuthatch). It prioritizes areas for open pine conservation based on suitability for longleaf pine, feasibility of prescribed burning, proximity to protected lands, habitat suitability for focal bird species, and proximity to bird source populations. It originates from the East Gulf Coastal Plain Joint Venture's prioritization of areas for open pine ecosystem restoration.



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Priority for open pine conservation for focal bird species

- High priority (score >80-100)
- Medium-high priority (score >60-80)
- Medium priority (score >40-60)
- Medium-low priority (score >20-40)
- Low priority (score 0-20)
- Not a priority (not identified as upland pine)

Table 6: Indicator values for East Coastal Plain open pine birds within Alabama. A good condition threshold is not yet defined for this indicator.

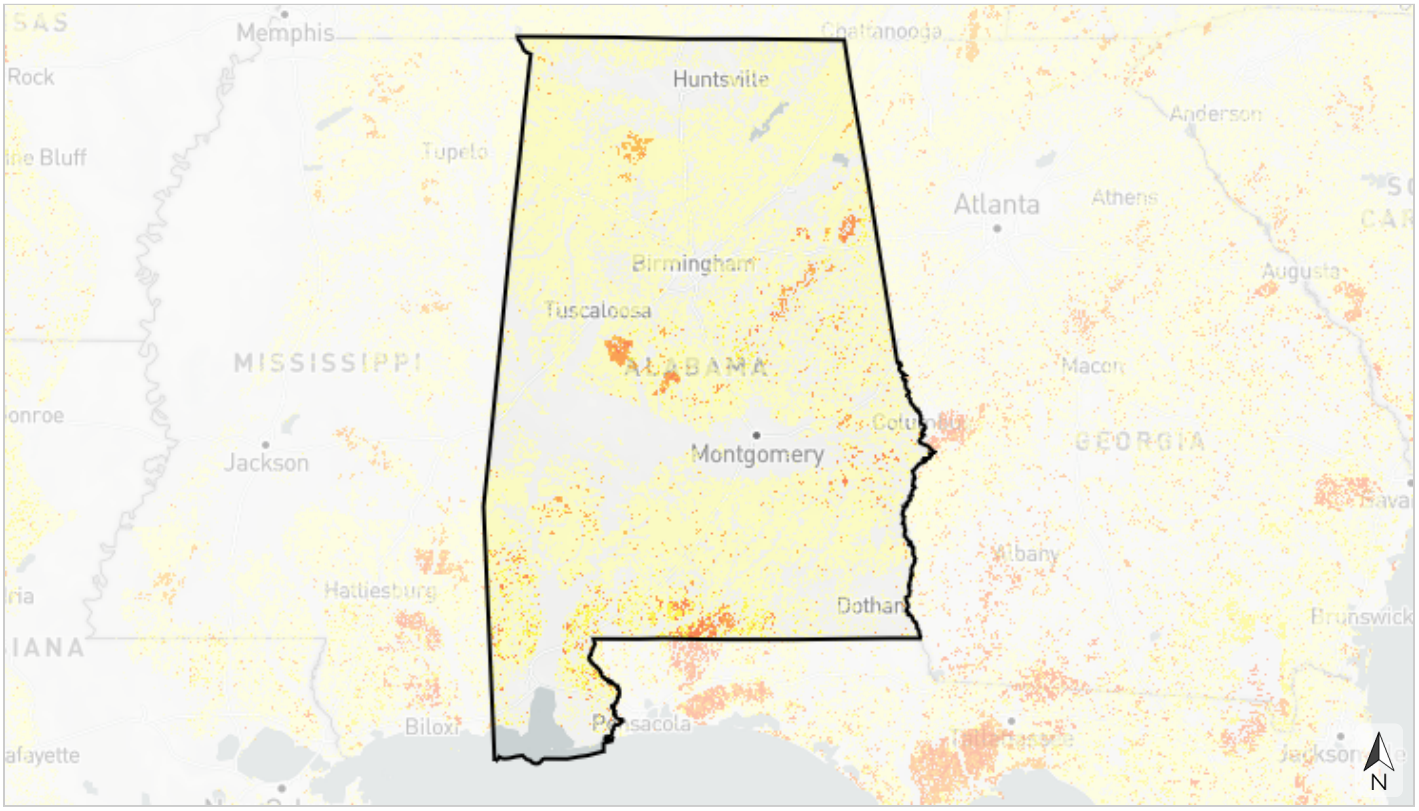
	Indicator Values: Priority for open pine conservation for focal bird species	Acres	Percent of Area
↑ High	High priority (score >80-100)	0	0%
	Medium-high priority (score >60-80)	65,965	0.2%
	Medium priority (score >40-60)	724,158	2.2%
	Medium-low priority (score >20-40)	4,675,958	13.9%
	Low priority (score 0-20)	3,007,695	9.0%
↓ Low	Not a priority (not identified as upland pine)	13,449,599	40.1%
	Area not evaluated for this indicator	*11,625,434*	*34.7%*
	Total area	**33,548,808**	**100%**

To learn more and explore the GIS data, view this indicator in the SECAS Atlas.

Terrestrial

Fire frequency

This indicator uses remote sensing, fire treatment data, and historical landcover models to assess whether an area matches its historical fire regime now and in the recent past (1984-2024). It focuses on fire-adapted forests and grasslands that historically burned at least once every 20 years, which rely on regular, low-intensity fires to maintain habitat, support native plant growth, and reduce wildfire risk. It evaluates departure from historical conditions based on the U.S. Forest Service's fire regime condition classes. This indicator combines Landsat-based fire history metrics from the U.S. Geological Survey, fire treatment data from LANDFIRE, and historical fire regime estimates from LANDFIRE. Development of fire history metrics was supported by Southeast FireMap.



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How well fire-adapted areas match their historic fire regime under current conditions vs. recent past (1984-2024)

- Currently in historical fire regime, low (<33%) departure in recent past
- Currently in historical fire regime, medium (33-66%) departure in recent past
- Currently in historical fire regime, high (>66%) departure in recent past
- Not currently in historical fire regime, low (<33%) departure in recent past
- Not currently in historical fire regime, medium (33-66%) departure in recent past
- Not currently in historical fire regime, high (>66%) departure in recent past
- Urban, row crop, or not a fire-adapted area (>20-year fire regime)

Table 7: Indicator values for fire frequency within Alabama. Good condition thresholds reflect the range of indicator values that occur in healthy, functioning ecosystems.

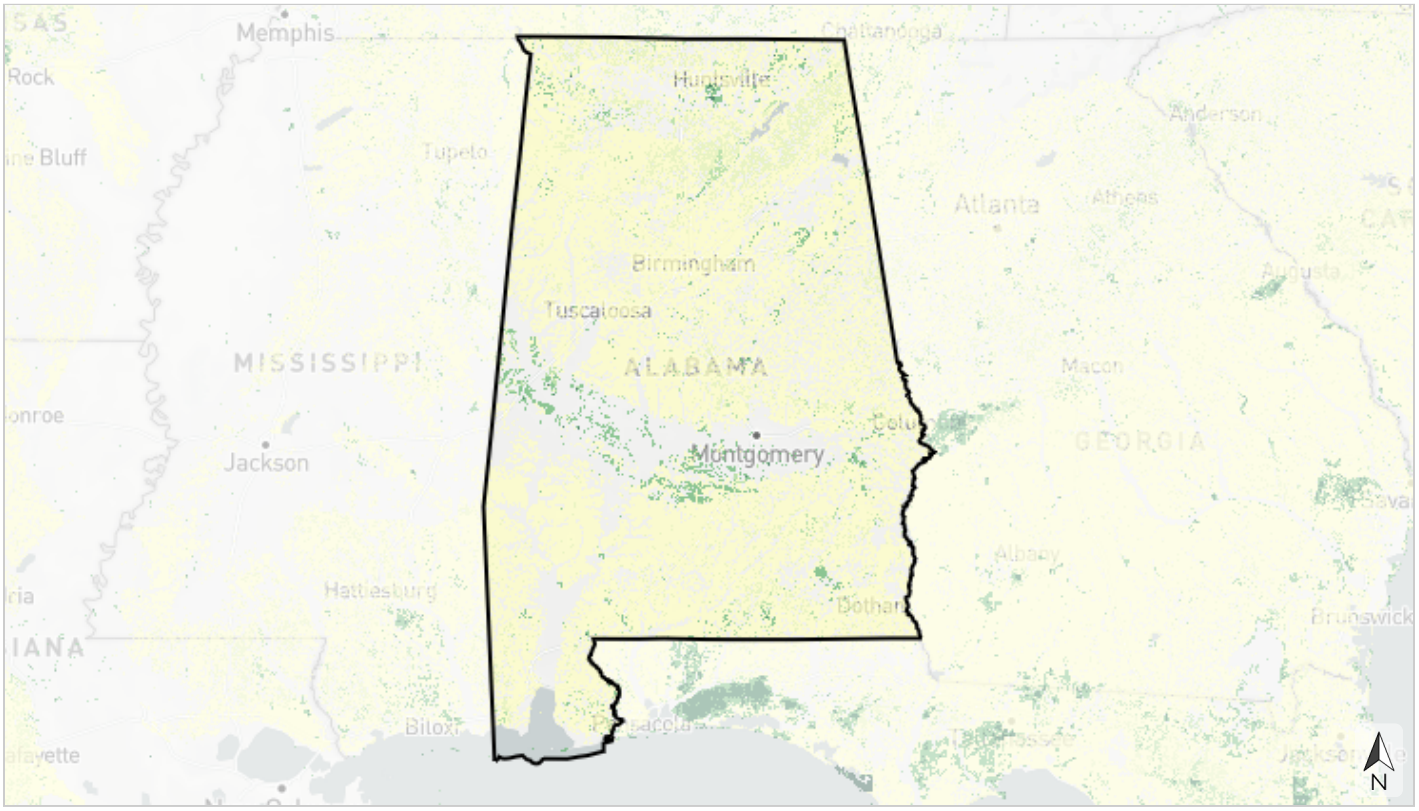
	Indicator Values: How well fire-adapted areas match their historic fire regime under current conditions vs. recent past (1984-2024)	Acres	Percent of Area	
↑ High	Currently in historical fire regime, low (<33%) departure in recent past	106,483	0.3%	
	Currently in historical fire regime, medium (33-66%) departure in recent past	610,970	1.8%	↑ In good condition
	Currently in historical fire regime, high (>66%) departure in recent past	355,791	1.1%	↓ Not in good condition
	Not currently in historical fire regime, low (<33%) departure in recent past	12,184	<0.1%	
	Not currently in historical fire regime, medium (33-66%) departure in recent past	817,485	2.4%	
	Not currently in historical fire regime, high (>66%) departure in recent past	15,543,783	46.3%	
↓ Low	Urban, row crop, or not a fire-adapted area (>20-year fire regime)	16,101,700	48.0%	
	Area not evaluated for this indicator	*412*	*<0.1%*	
	Total area	**33,548,808**	**100%**	

To learn more and explore the GIS data, view this indicator in the SECAS Atlas.

Terrestrial

Grassland & savanna extent

This indicator represents grasslands and savannas in the southeastern United States, which support important plants, reptiles, amphibians, mammals, birds, and pollinators. It considers known grassland and savanna locations, predicted locations within protected areas, and surrounding pollinator buffers. It also incorporates other potential grassland and savanna locations within natural and altered landscapes, and restoration opportunities within historical locations based on past fire intervals and historic ecosystem predictions. This indicator combines data from multiple sources, including the Southeastern Grasslands Institute, the National Land Cover Database, LANDFIRE, Oklahoma and Texas ecological systems maps, and more.



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- Known grassland/savanna
- Likely grassland/savanna >10 acres
- Likely grassland/savanna ≤10 acres
- Pollinator buffer around known or likely grassland/savanna
- Potential grassland/savanna in grassland/savanna hub
- Potential grassland/savanna outside grassland/savanna hub
- Historic grassland/savanna
- Not identified as grassland/savanna

Table 8: Indicator values for grassland & savanna extent within Alabama. Good condition thresholds reflect the range of indicator values that occur in healthy, functioning ecosystems.

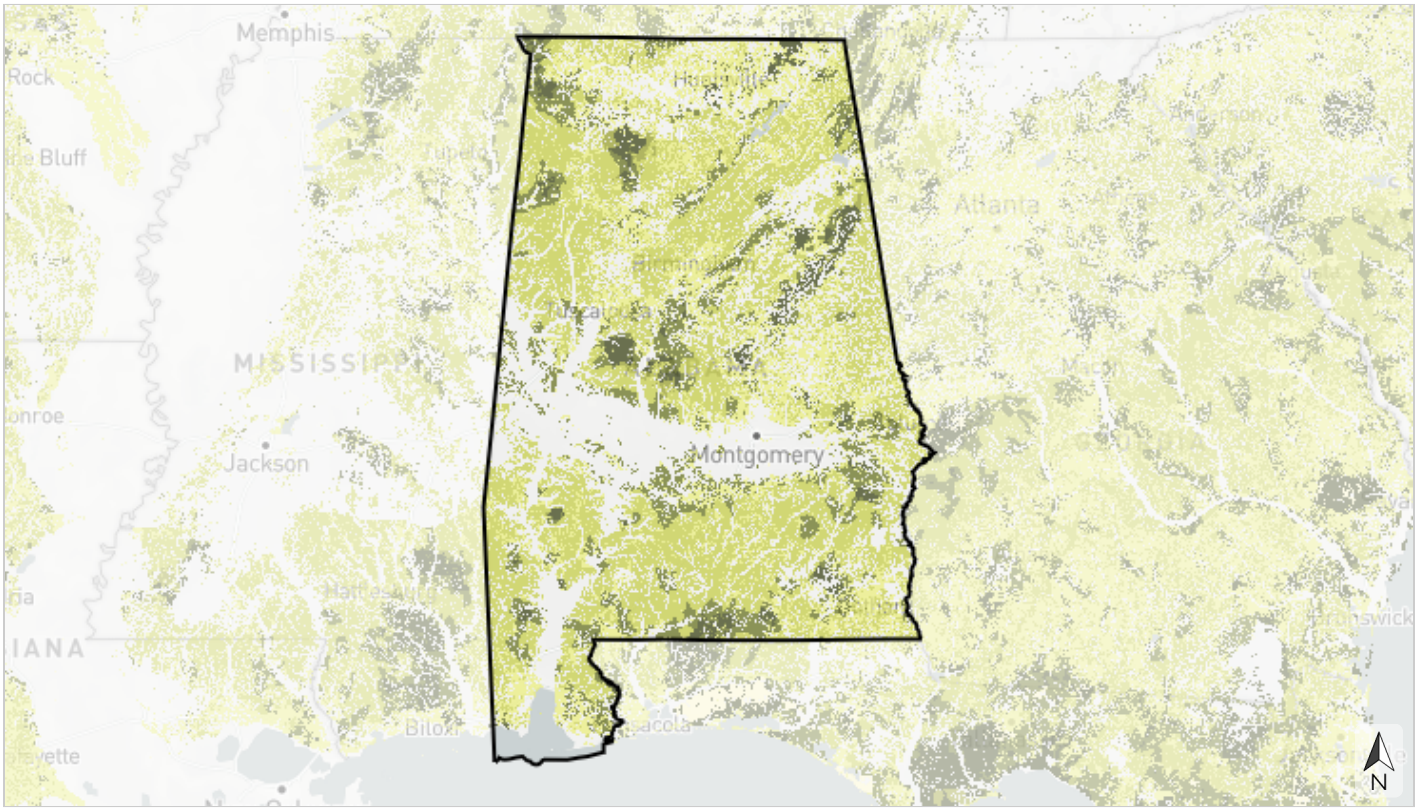
	Indicator Values	Acres	Percent of Area	
↑ High	Known grassland/savanna	16,913	<0.1%	
	Likely grassland/savanna >10 acres	37,283	0.1%	
	Likely grassland/savanna ≤10 acres	22,821	<0.1%	↑ In good condition
	Pollinator buffer around known or likely grassland/savanna	604,412	1.8%	↓ Not in good condition
	Potential grassland/savanna in grassland/savanna hub	916,119	2.7%	
	Potential grassland/savanna outside grassland/savanna hub	2,712,541	8.1%	
	Historic grassland/savanna	16,822,306	50.1%	
↓ Low	Not identified as grassland/savanna	12,409,191	37.0%	
	Area not evaluated for this indicator	*7,223*	*<0.1%*	
	Total area	**33,548,808**	**100%**	

To learn more and explore the GIS data, view this indicator in the SECAS Atlas.

Terrestrial

Grassland & savanna restoration

This indicator represents potential restoration opportunities for grasslands and savannas within their historical range in the southeastern United States. Grasslands support important plants, reptiles, amphibians, mammals, birds, and pollinators, but have significantly declined from their current extent. It considers proximity to clusters of existing grasslands and savannas, protected areas with management potential, landcover classes with good restoration potential, priority areas for restoration of longleaf and shortleaf pine, and historical grassland and savanna locations. This indicator combines data from multiple sources, including the Southeast Blueprint grassland and savanna extent indicator, the Longleaf Suitability Analysis, shortleaf pine suitability, landcover from the National Land Cover Database and LANDFIRE, and more.



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Restoration priority

- Highest (in a grassland/savanna hub, in a protected area with management potential, in a historic patch >10 acres)
- Very high (in a grassland/savanna hub, unprotected landcover with good restoration potential, in a historic patch >10 acres)
- High (outside a grassland/savanna hub, in a protected area with management potential, in a historic patch >10 acres)
- Medium (outside a grassland/savanna hub, unprotected landcover with good restoration potential, in a historic patch >10 acres)
- Low (other historic grassland/savanna)
- Very low (already known or likely grassland/savanna)
- Lowest (not identified as historic grassland/savanna)

Table 9: Indicator values for grassland & savanna restoration within Alabama. A good condition threshold is not yet defined for this indicator.

	Indicator Values: Restoration priority	Acres	Percent of Area
↑ High	Highest (in a grassland/savanna hub, in a protected area with management potential, in a historic patch >10 acres)	748,473	2.2%
	Very high (in a grassland/savanna hub, unprotected landcover with good restoration potential, in a historic patch >10 acres)	2,964,324	8.8%
	High (outside a grassland/savanna hub, in a protected area with management potential, in a historic patch >10 acres)	132,888	0.4%
	Medium (outside a grassland/savanna hub, unprotected landcover with good restoration potential, in a historic patch >10 acres)	8,992,371	26.8%
	Low (other historic grassland/savanna)	7,936,864	23.7%
	Very low (already known or likely grassland/savanna)	77,017	0.2%
↓ Low	Lowest (not identified as historic grassland/savanna)	12,689,647	37.8%
	Area not evaluated for this indicator	*7,223*	*<0.1%*
	Total area	**33,548,808**	**100%**

To learn more and explore the GIS data, view this indicator in the SECAS Atlas.

Terrestrial

Greenways & trails

This cultural resource indicator measures both the natural condition and connected length of greenways and trails to characterize the quality of the recreational experience. Natural condition is based on the amount of impervious surface surrounding the path. Connected length captures how far a person can go without leaving a dedicated path, based on common distances for walking, running, and biking. This indicator originates from OpenStreetMap data and the National Land Cover Database.



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- Mostly natural and connected for ≥40 km
- Mostly natural and connected for 5 to <40 km or partly natural and connected for ≥40 km
- Mostly natural and connected for 1.9 to <5 km, partly natural and connected for 5 to <40 km, or developed and connected for ≥40 km
- Mostly natural and connected for <1.9 km, partly natural and connected for 1.9 to <5 km, or developed and connected for 5 to <40 km
- Partly natural and connected for <1.9 km or developed and connected for 1.9 to <5 km
- Developed and connected for <1.9 km
- Sidewalk
- Not identified as a trail, sidewalk, or other path

Table 10: Indicator values for greenways & trails within Alabama. Good condition thresholds reflect the range of indicator values that occur in healthy, functioning ecosystems.

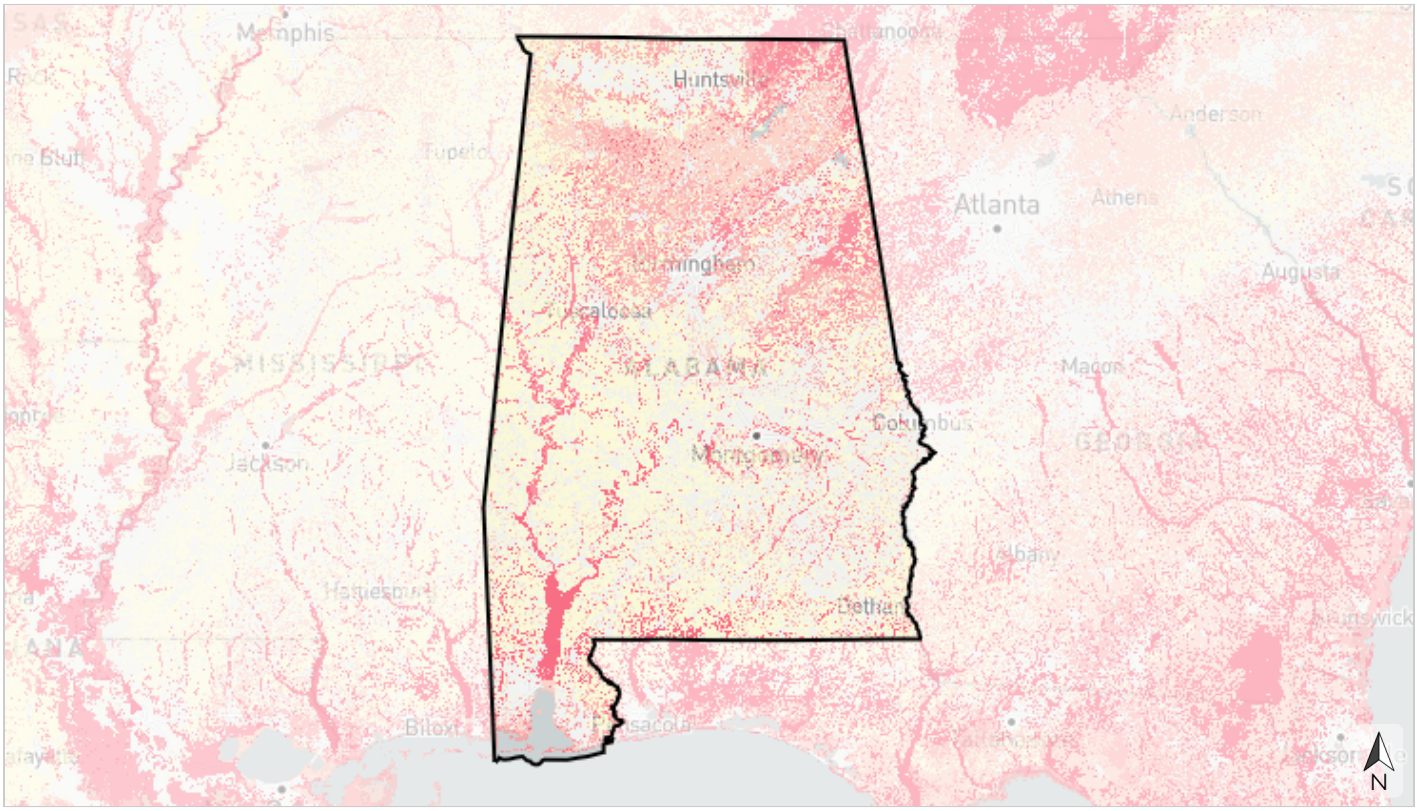
	Indicator Values	Acres	Percent of Area	
↑ High	Mostly natural and connected for ≥40 km	6,081	<0.1%	
	Mostly natural and connected for 5 to <40 km or partly natural and connected for ≥40 km	7,192	<0.1%	
	Mostly natural and connected for 1.9 to <5 km, partly natural and connected for 5 to <40 km, or developed and connected for ≥40 km	6,510	<0.1%	
	Mostly natural and connected for <1.9 km, partly natural and connected for 1.9 to <5 km, or developed and connected for 5 to <40 km	6,426	<0.1%	↑ In good condition
	Partly natural and connected for <1.9 km or developed and connected for 1.9 to <5 km	4,051	<0.1%	↓ Not in good condition
	Developed and connected for <1.9 km	5,985	<0.1%	
	Sidewalk	11,307	<0.1%	
↓ Low	Not identified as a trail, sidewalk, or other path	33,493,745	99.8%	
	Area not evaluated for this indicator	*7,511*	*<0.1%*	
	Total area	**33,548,808**	**100%**	

To learn more and explore the GIS data, view this indicator in the SECAS Atlas.

Terrestrial

Imperiled amphibians & reptiles

This indicator identifies potential habitat to support amphibian and reptile Regional Species of Greatest Conservation Need (RSGCN). Using a rarity-weighted richness approach, it prioritizes places important for species that are restricted to smaller ranges, such as narrow endemics, which are therefore more vulnerable to habitat loss or change. RSGCN are regional priority species derived from the list of SGCN identified in Southeast State Wildlife Action Plans as most in need of conservation action. RSGCN were chosen based on consistent criteria, such as level of conservation concern, regional stewardship responsibility, and ecological significance. This indicator uses 190 species and subspecies models from the U.S. Geological Survey Gap Analysis Project that are based on known ranges, habitat relationships, and LANDFIRE landcover.



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Importance for range-restricted species

- Highest importance (top 5%)
- Very high importance (upper 5-10%)
- High importance (upper 10-20%)
- Medium importance (above average)
- Low importance (below average)
- Developed landcover or no potential habitat

Table 11: Indicator values for imperiled amphibians & reptiles within Alabama. A good condition threshold is not yet defined for this indicator.

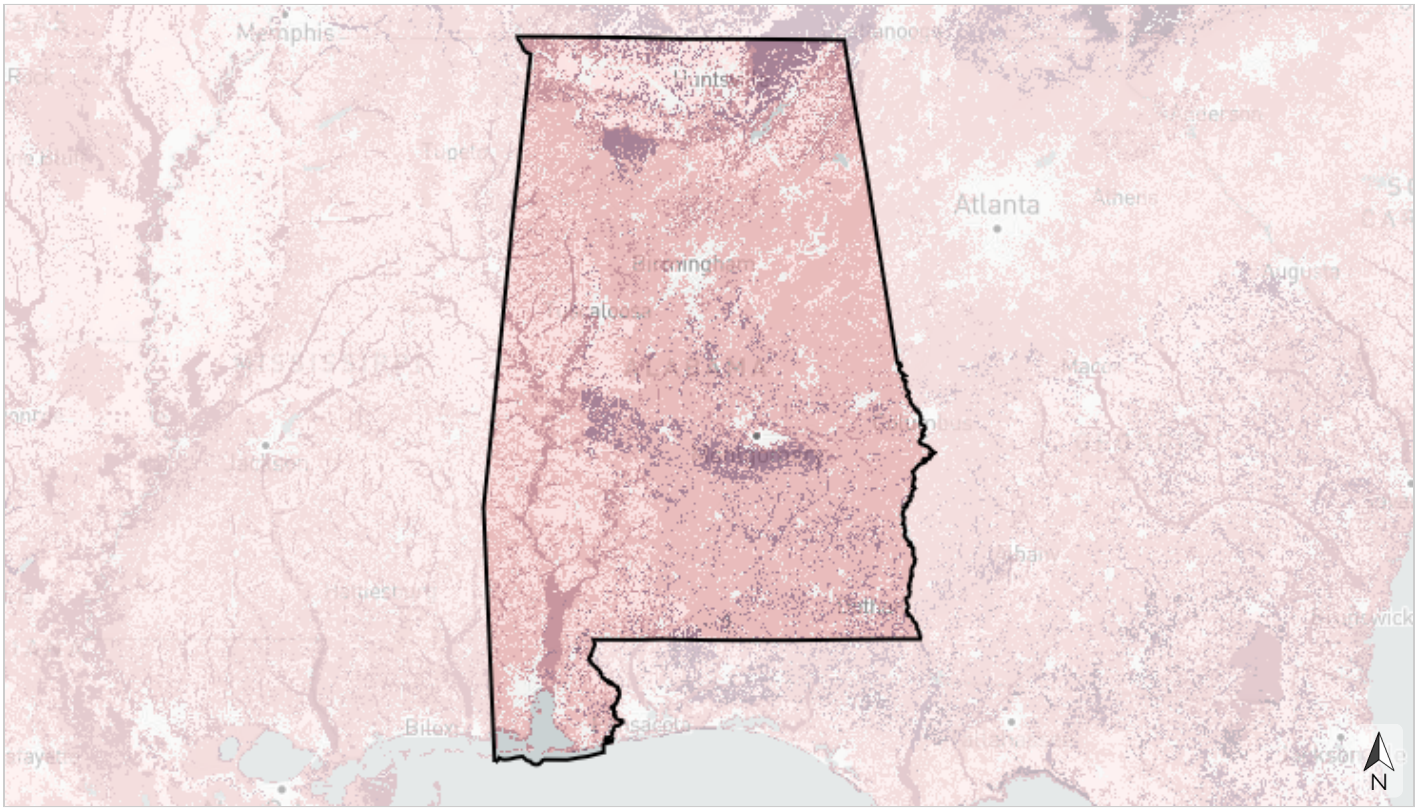
	Indicator Values: Importance for range-restricted species	Acres	Percent of Area
↑ High	Highest importance (top 5%)	2,095,497	6.2%
	Very high importance (upper 5-10%)	2,278,025	6.8%
	High importance (upper 10-20%)	3,743,411	11.2%
	Medium importance (above average)	4,737,220	14.1%
	Low importance (below average)	10,969,739	32.7%
↓ Low	Developed landcover or no potential habitat	9,272,894	27.6%
	Area not evaluated for this indicator	*452,021*	*1.3%*
	Total area	**33,548,808**	**100%**

To learn more and explore the GIS data, view this indicator in the SECAS Atlas.

Terrestrial

Imperiled mammals

This indicator identifies potential habitat to support mammal Regional Species of Greatest Conservation Need (RSGCN). Using a rarity-weighted richness approach, it prioritizes places important for species that are restricted to smaller ranges, such as narrow endemics, which are therefore more vulnerable to habitat loss or change. RSGCN are regional priority species derived from the list of SGCN identified in Southeast State Wildlife Action Plans as most in need of conservation action. RSGCN were chosen based on consistent criteria, such as level of conservation concern, regional stewardship responsibility, and ecological significance. This indicator uses 58 species models from the U.S. Geological Survey Gap Analysis Project that are based on known ranges, habitat relationships, and LANDFIRE landcover.



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Importance for range-restricted species

- Highest importance (top 5%)
- Very high importance (upper 5-10%)
- High importance (upper 10-20%)
- Medium importance (above average)
- Low importance (below average)
- Developed landcover or no potential habitat

Table 12: Indicator values for imperiled mammals within Alabama. A good condition threshold is not yet defined for this indicator.

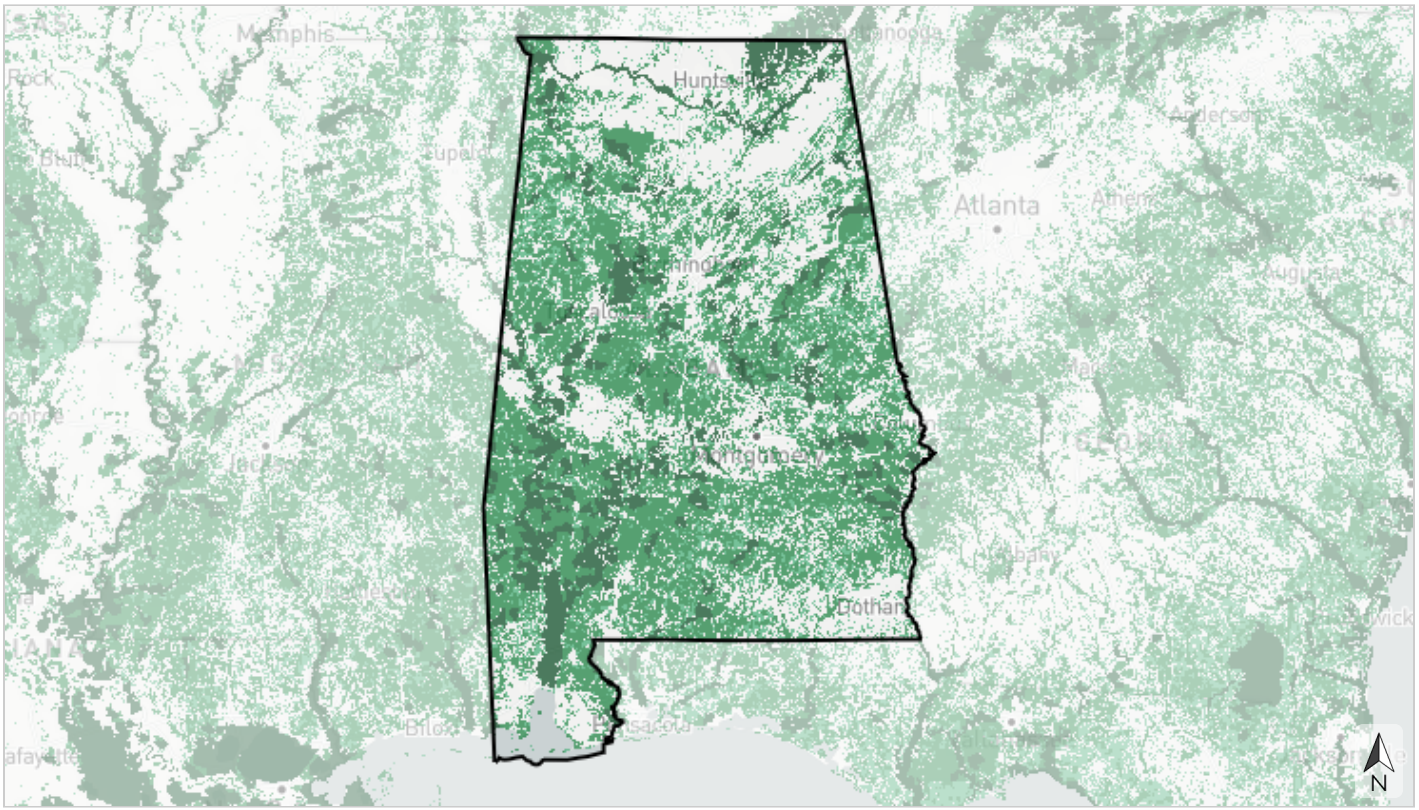
	Indicator Values: Importance for range-restricted species	Acres	Percent of Area
↑ High	Highest importance (top 5%)	183,317	0.5%
	Very high importance (upper 5-10%)	3,186,087	9.5%
	High importance (upper 10-20%)	3,671,472	10.9%
	Medium importance (above average)	15,980,885	47.6%
	Low importance (below average)	6,394,738	19.1%
↓ Low	Developed landcover or no potential habitat	3,680,288	11.0%
	Area not evaluated for this indicator	*452,021*	*1.3%*
	Total area	**33,548,808**	**100%**

To learn more and explore the GIS data, view this indicator in the SECAS Atlas.

Terrestrial

Intact habitat cores

This indicator represents the size of large, unfragmented patches of natural habitat. It identifies minimally disturbed natural areas at least 100 acres in size and greater than 200 meters wide. Large areas of intact natural habitat are important for many wildlife species, including reptiles and amphibians, birds, and large mammals. This indicator originates from Esri's green infrastructure data.



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- Large core (>10,000 acres)
- Medium core (>1,000-10,000 acres)
- Small core (>100-1,000 acres)
- Not a core

Table 13: Indicator values for intact habitat cores within Alabama. Good condition thresholds reflect the range of indicator values that occur in healthy, functioning ecosystems.

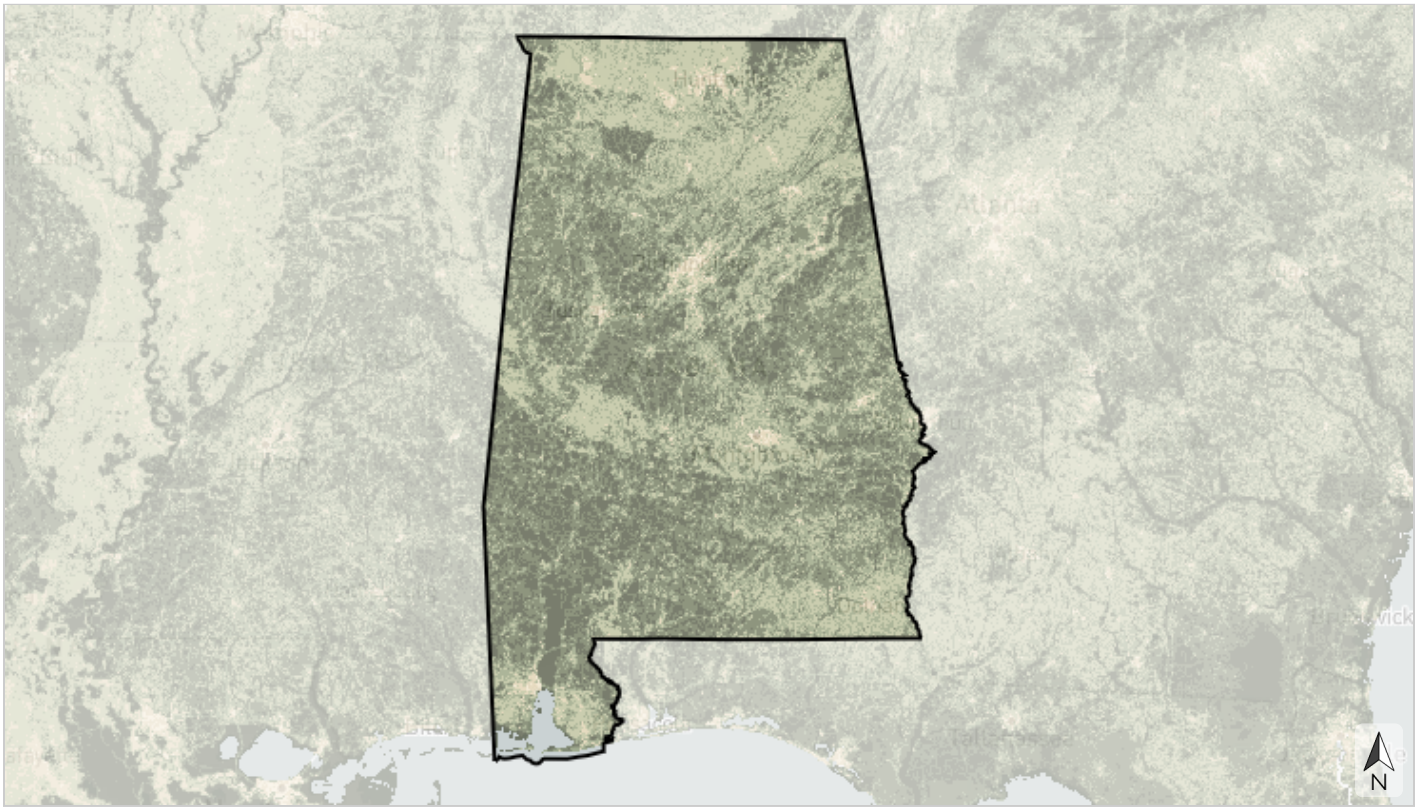
	Indicator Values	Acres	Percent of Area	
↑ High	Large core (>10,000 acres)	3,900,079	11.6%	
	Medium core (>1,000-10,000 acres)	11,675,985	34.8%	
	Small core (>100-1,000 acres)	3,998,227	11.9%	↑ In good condition
↓ Low	Not a core	13,974,121	41.7%	↓ Not in good condition
	Area not evaluated for this indicator	*397*	*<0.1%*	
	Total area	**33,548,808**	**100%**	

To learn more and explore the GIS data, view this indicator in the SECAS Atlas.

Terrestrial

Landscape condition

This indicator represents natural areas with limited human alteration while also considering the naturalness of the surrounding landscape. Examples of human alteration include urban development and intense agricultural use. The degree of naturalness across the landscape is a key ecological condition for sustaining species and ecosystem services that are sensitive to habitat fragmentation at multiple scales. This indicator combines data from multiple sources, including the National Land Cover Database; various data on grasslands, mines, quarries, and reservoirs; ideas from the Florida Critical Lands and Waters Identification Project's approach for evaluating land use intensity; and more.



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- Very natural landscape
- Natural landscape
- Mostly natural landscape
- Partly natural landscape
- Altered landscape
- Heavily altered landscape

Table 14: Indicator values for landscape condition within Alabama. Good condition thresholds reflect the range of indicator values that occur in healthy, functioning ecosystems.

	Indicator Values	Acres	Percent of Area	
↑ High	Very natural landscape	4,617,560	13.8%	
	Natural landscape	11,657,654	34.7%	
	Mostly natural landscape	8,690,007	25.9%	↑ In good condition
	Partly natural landscape	7,363,199	21.9%	↓ Not in good condition
	Altered landscape	634,693	1.9%	
↓ Low	Heavily altered landscape	133,673	0.4%	
	Area not evaluated for this indicator	*452,021*	*1.3%*	
	Total area	**33,548,808**	**100%**	

To learn more and explore the GIS data, view this indicator in the SECAS Atlas.

Terrestrial

Potential access to parks

This cultural resource indicator prioritizes places to create new parks that would fill gaps in access to open space within socially vulnerable communities in urban areas. It identifies areas where residents currently lack access to parks within a 10-minute walk (accounting for walkable road networks and access barriers like highways and fences), then prioritizes based on park need using demographic and environmental metrics. Parks help improve public health, foster a conservation ethic by providing opportunities for people to connect with nature, and support critical ecosystem services. This indicator originates from the Trust for Public Land's ParkServe park priority areas and the Center for Disease Control's Social Vulnerability Index.



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Priority for a new park to serve people who lack nearby park access

- Very high priority
- High priority
- Moderate priority
- Not identified as a priority (within urban areas)

Table 15: Indicator values for potential access to parks within Alabama. A good condition threshold is not yet defined for this indicator.

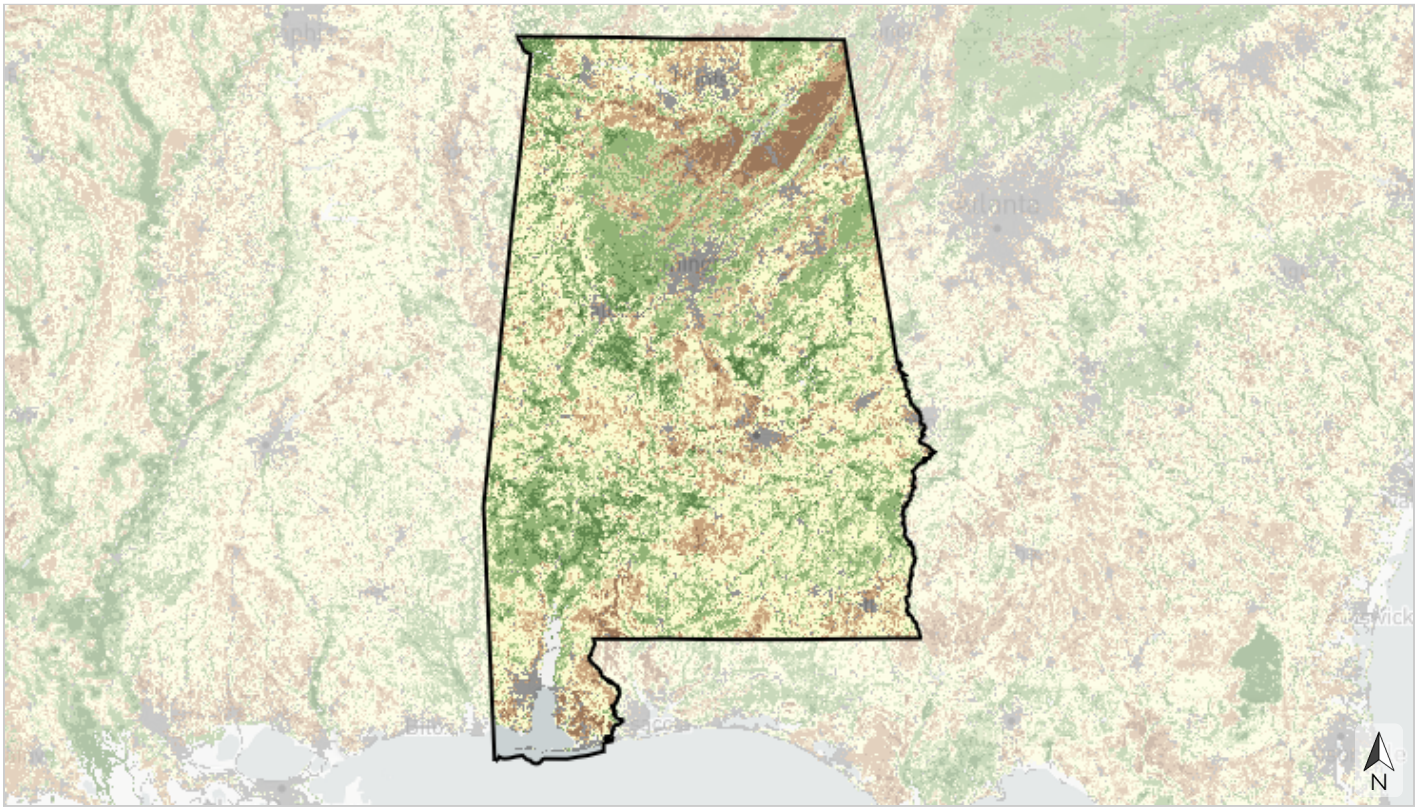
	Indicator Values: Priority for a new park to serve people who lack nearby park access	Acres	Percent of Area
↑ High	Very high priority	143,497	0.4%
	High priority	202,376	0.6%
	Moderate priority	252,444	0.8%
↓ Low	Not identified as a priority (within urban areas)	32,487,385	96.8%
	Area not evaluated for this indicator	*463,106*	*1.4%*
	Total area	**33,548,808**	**100%**

To learn more and explore the GIS data, view this indicator in the SECAS Atlas.

Terrestrial

Resilient terrestrial sites

This indicator depicts an area's capacity to maintain species diversity and ecosystem function in the face of climate change. It measures two factors that influence resilience. The first, landscape diversity, reflects the number of microhabitats and climatic gradients created by topography, elevation, and hydrology. The second, local connectedness, reflects the degree of habitat fragmentation and strength of barriers to species movement. Highly resilient sites contain many different habitat niches that support biodiversity, and allow species to move freely through the landscape to find suitable microclimates as the climate changes. This indicator originates from The Nature Conservancy's Resilient Land data.



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- Most resilient
- More resilient
- Slightly more resilient
- Average/median resilience
- Slightly less resilient
- Less resilient
- Least resilient
- Developed

Table 16: Indicator values for resilient terrestrial sites within Alabama. A good condition threshold is not yet defined for this indicator.

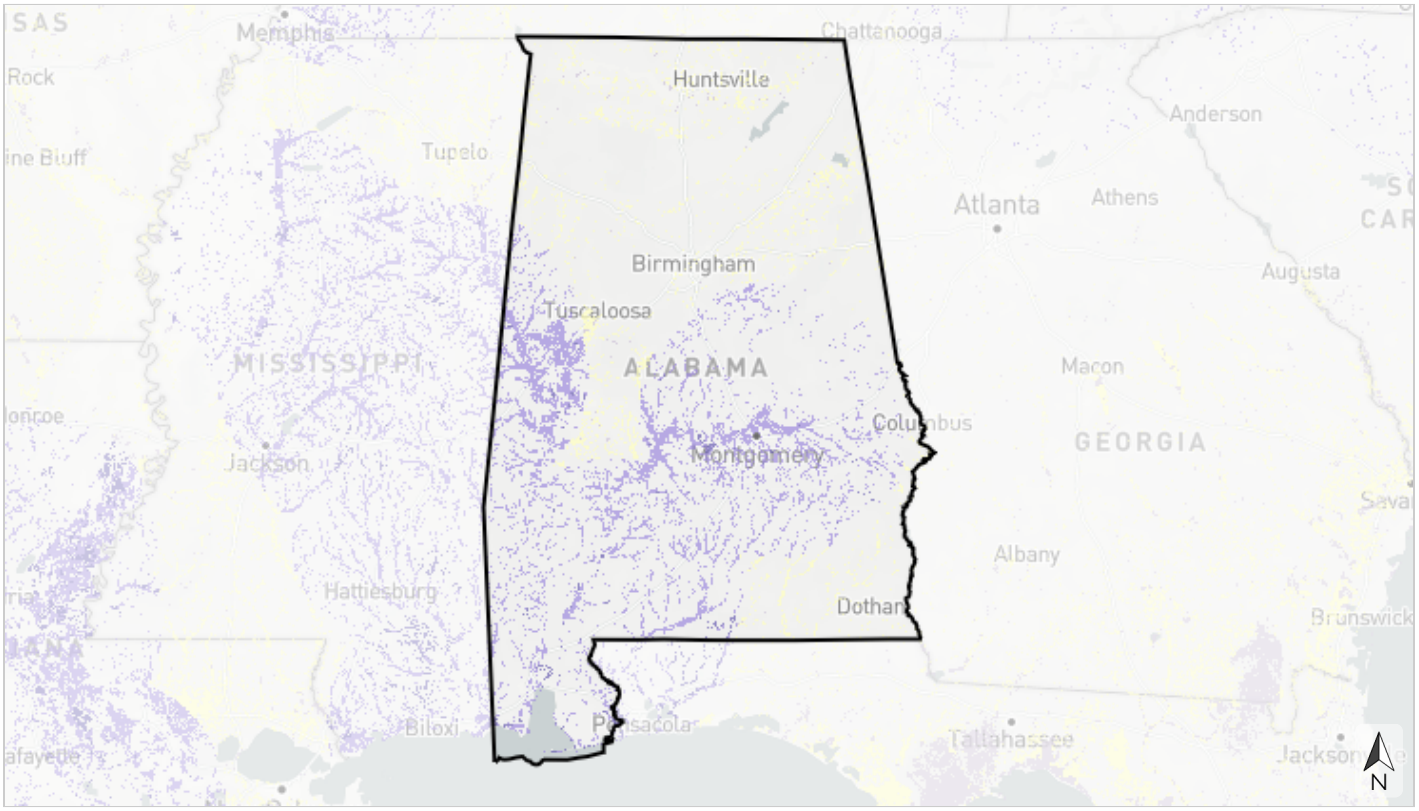
	Indicator Values	Acres	Percent of Area
↑ High	Most resilient	1,210,231	3.6%
	More resilient	5,779,928	17.2%
	Slightly more resilient	5,711,489	17.0%
	Average/median resilience	9,238,993	27.5%
	Slightly less resilient	3,349,221	10.0%
	Less resilient	2,923,690	8.7%
	Least resilient	1,019,406	3.0%
↓ Low	Developed	2,990,250	8.9%
	Area not evaluated for this indicator	*1,325,600*	*4.0%*
	Total area	**33,548,808**	**100%**

To learn more and explore the GIS data, view this indicator in the SECAS Atlas.

Terrestrial

River cane restoration

This indicator represents priority places for river cane restoration and co-stewardship near the lands of federally recognized Tribes. River cane is a bamboo species native to the Southeast. Historically, it was abundant and widespread, forming dense patches called canebrakes that could stretch for miles within the floodplain. Today, it has been reduced to less than 2% of its former extent. River cane not only provides significant habitat value and ecosystem services, but many Southeastern Native American Tribes consider it a cultural keystone species important to the continuity of traditional lifeways. This indicator combines data from multiple sources, including Natural Resources Conservation Service soils data, the Environmental Protection Agency's estimated floodplain, lands of federally recognized Tribes lands from the U.S. Census Bureau, and more.



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- Potential river cane restoration/management area on Tribal land
- Potential river cane restoration/management area on protected land near Tribal lands
- Potential river cane restoration/management area near Tribal lands
- Potential river cane restoration/management area on protected land
- Potential river cane restoration/management area
- Not identified as a rivercane restoration/management area

Table 17: Indicator values for river cane restoration within Alabama. A good condition threshold is not yet defined for this indicator.

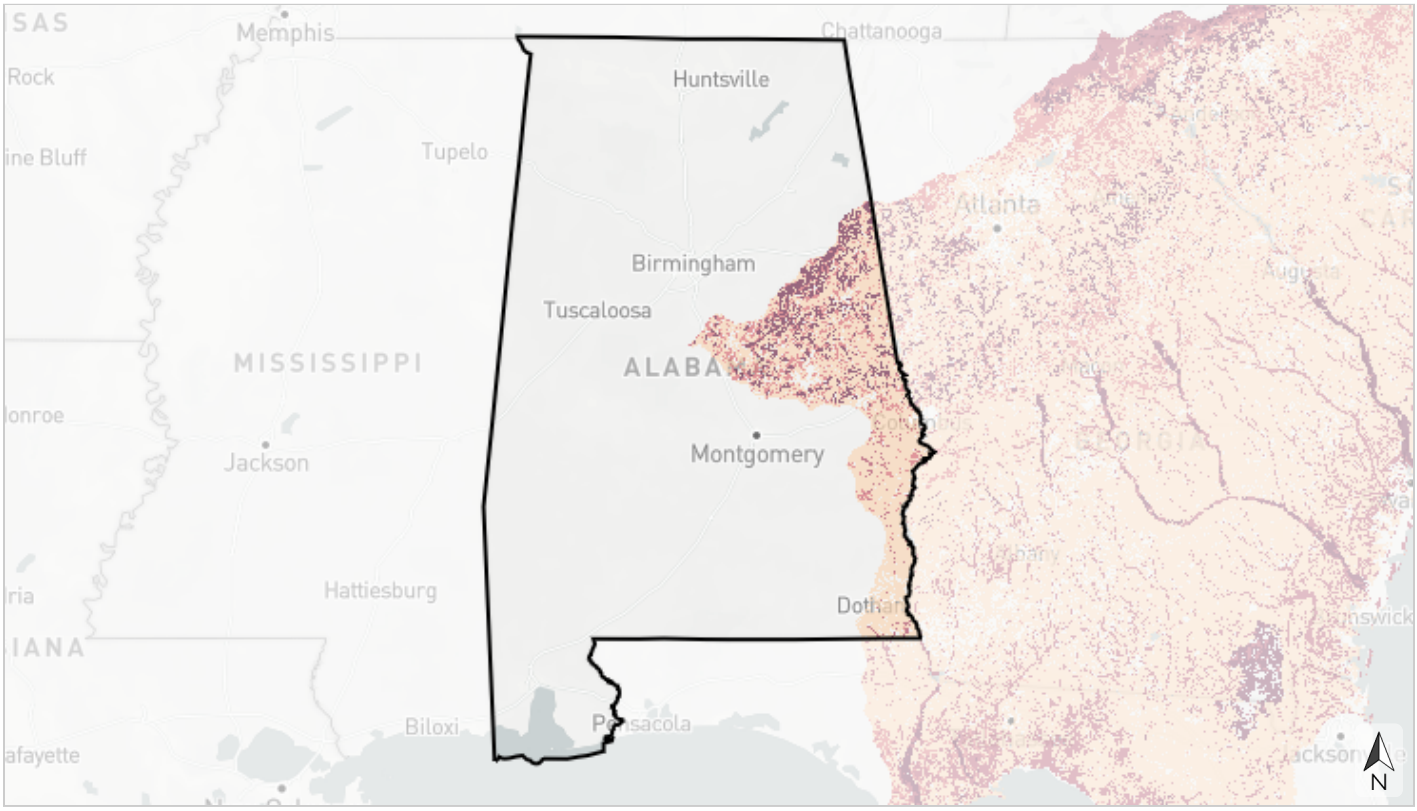
	Indicator Values	Acres	Percent of Area
↑ High	Potential river cane restoration/management area on Tribal land	76	<0.1%
	Potential river cane restoration/management area on protected land near Tribal lands	149,500	0.4%
	Potential river cane restoration/management area near Tribal lands	3,333,070	9.9%
	Potential river cane restoration/management area on protected land	102,278	0.3%
	Potential river cane restoration/management area	1,885,589	5.6%
↓ Low	Not identified as a rivercane restoration/management area	27,582,582	82.2%
	Area not evaluated for this indicator	*495,713*	*1.5%*
	Total area	**33,548,808**	**100%**

To learn more and explore the GIS data, view this indicator in the SECAS Atlas.

Terrestrial

South Atlantic forest birds

This indicator is an index of habitat suitability for twelve upland hardwood and forested wetland bird species (wood thrush, whip-poor-will, American woodcock, red-headed woodpecker, Chuck-will's widow, hooded warbler, Kentucky warbler, Acadian flycatcher, Northern parula, black-throated green warbler, prothonotary warbler, Swainson's warbler) based on patch size and other ecosystem characteristics such as proximity to water and proximity to forest and ecotone edge. The needs of these species are increasingly restrictive at higher index values, reflecting better quality habitat. It originates from Southeast Gap Analysis Project and Designing Sustainable Landscapes bird habitat models.



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Potential for presence of forest bird index species

- Very large patches near water (potential for Swainson's warbler)
- Large patches often near water (potential for Northern parula, black-throated green warbler, or Prothonotary warbler)
- Medium patches (potential for Acadian flycatcher)
- Small patches often near water (potential for hooded warbler or Kentucky warbler)
- Very small patches or near open areas (potential for wood thrush, whip-poor-will, red-headed woodpecker, Chuck-will's widow, or American woodcock)
- Less potential

Table 18: Indicator values for South Atlantic forest birds within Alabama. Good condition thresholds reflect the range of indicator values that occur in healthy, functioning ecosystems.

	Indicator Values: Potential for presence of forest bird index species	Acres	Percent of Area	
↑ High	Very large patches near water (potential for Swainson's warbler)	483,605	1.4%	
	Large patches often near water (potential for Northern parula, black-throated green warbler, or Prothonotary warbler)	108,724	0.3%	
	Medium patches (potential for Acadian flycatcher)	707,641	2.1%	
	Small patches often near water (potential for hooded warbler or Kentucky warbler)	222,026	0.7%	↑ In good condition
	Very small patches or near open areas (potential for wood thrush, whip-poor-will, red-headed woodpecker, Chuck-will's widow, or American woodcock)	2,561,244	7.6%	↓ Not in good condition
↓ Low	Less potential	580,727	1.7%	
	Area not evaluated for this indicator	*28,884,842*	*86.1%*	
	Total area	**33,548,808**	**100%**	

To learn more and explore the GIS data, view this indicator in the SECAS Atlas.

Terrestrial

South Atlantic low-urban historic landscapes

This cultural resource indicator is an index of sites on the National Register of Historic Places surrounded by limited urban development. It identifies significant historical places that remain connected to their context in the natural world. It uses the National Land Cover Database and historic places data from the National Park Service and various state historic resource agencies.



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- Historic place with nearby low-urban buffer
- Historic place with nearby high-urban buffer
- Not in the National Register of Historic Places

Table 19: Indicator values for South Atlantic low-urban historic landscapes within Alabama. A good condition threshold is not yet defined for this indicator.

	Indicator Values	Acres	Percent of Area
↑ High	Historic place with nearby low-urban buffer	148	<0.1%
	Historic place with nearby high-urban buffer	276	<0.1%
↓ Low	Not in the National Register of Historic Places	4,504,642	13.4%
	Area not evaluated for this indicator	*29,043,742*	*86.6%*
	Total area	**33,548,808**	**100%**

To learn more and explore the GIS data, view this indicator in the SECAS Atlas.

Terrestrial

Urban park size

This cultural resource indicator measures the size of parks larger than 5 acres in the urban environment. Protected natural areas in urban environments provide urban residents a nearby place to connect with nature, and offer refugia for some species. This indicator complements the equitable access to potential parks indicator by capturing the value of existing parks. It originates from the Protected Areas Database of the United States, U.S. Census Bureau urban areas, and the National Land Cover Database.



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- 75+ acre urban park
- 50 to <75 acre urban park
- 30 to <50 acre urban park
- 10 to <30 acre urban park
- 5 to <10 acre urban park
- <5 acre urban park
- Not identified as an urban park

Table 20: Indicator values for urban park size within Alabama. A good condition threshold is not yet defined for this indicator.

	Indicator Values	Acres	Percent of Area
↑ High	75+ acre urban park	145,631	0.4%
	50 to <75 acre urban park	4,152	<0.1%
	30 to <50 acre urban park	3,734	<0.1%
	10 to <30 acre urban park	6,276	<0.1%
	5 to <10 acre urban park	2,125	<0.1%
	<5 acre urban park	2,043	<0.1%
↓ Low	Not identified as an urban park	33,316,941	99.3%
	Area not evaluated for this indicator	*67,907*	*0.2%*
	Total area	**33,548,808**	**100%**

To learn more and explore the GIS data, view this indicator in the SECAS Atlas.

Freshwater

Floodplain inundation

This indicator uses the frequency of inundation to measure the hydrologic function of the floodplain. In a natural floodplain, water can move freely from mainstem rivers and lakes onto different parts of the floodplain. This cycle of frequent, but not persistent, flooding supports many aquatic species and habitats, like fish, waterfowl and swamp forests. It also provides essential ecosystem services such as nutrient retention and downstream flood control. When parts of the floodplain stay constantly wet or dry, this may signal negative impacts from structures like dikes, dams, and levees, which disconnect waterbodies from their adjacent floodplains. This indicator is based on Sentinel-2 satellite imagery and methods developed by Yvonne Allen of the U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service.



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Frequency of inundation within the floodplain

- Frequent inundation (flooded in 21-90% of days with available data)
- Regular inundation (flooded in 6-20% of days with available data)
- Occasional inundation (flooded in 2-5% of days with available data)
- Persistent inundation (flooded in 91-100% of days with available data)
- No detected inundation (flooded in 0% of days with available data)
- Not identified as a floodplain

Table 21: Indicator values for floodplain inundation within Alabama. Good condition thresholds reflect the range of indicator values that occur in healthy, functioning ecosystems.

	Indicator Values: Frequency of inundation within the floodplain	Acres	Percent of Area	
↑ High	Frequent inundation (flooded in 21-90% of days with available data)	484,662	1.4%	
	Regular inundation (flooded in 6-20% of days with available data)	493,609	1.5%	↑ In good condition
	Occasional inundation (flooded in 2-5% of days with available data)	526,974	1.6%	↓ Not in good condition
	Persistent inundation (flooded in 91-100% of days with available data)	790,967	2.4%	
	No detected inundation (flooded in 0% of days with available data)	3,172,758	9.5%	
↓ Low	Not identified as a floodplain	27,957,939	83.3%	
	Area not evaluated for this indicator	*121,898*	*0.4%*	
	Total area	**33,548,808**	**100%**	

To learn more and explore the GIS data, view this indicator in the SECAS Atlas.

Freshwater

Gulf migratory fish connectivity

This indicator captures how far upstream migratory fish in the Gulf of America have been observed. How far upstream migratory fish can travel reflects not just the presence of dams and other barriers, but also the presence of measures like fish ladders that allow specific species to access habitat upstream of dams. This indicator originates from The Nature Conservancy's Southeast Aquatic Connectivity Assessment Project and applies to the Environmental Protection Agency's estimated floodplain, which spatially defines areas estimated to be inundated by a 100-year flood (also known as the 1% annual chance flood).





- Presence of Gulf sturgeon
- Presence of Alabama shad, American shad, or striped bass
- Not identified as Gulf migratory fish habitat (east of the Mississippi River)

Table 22: Indicator values for Gulf migratory fish connectivity within Alabama. Good condition thresholds reflect the range of indicator values that occur in healthy, functioning ecosystems.

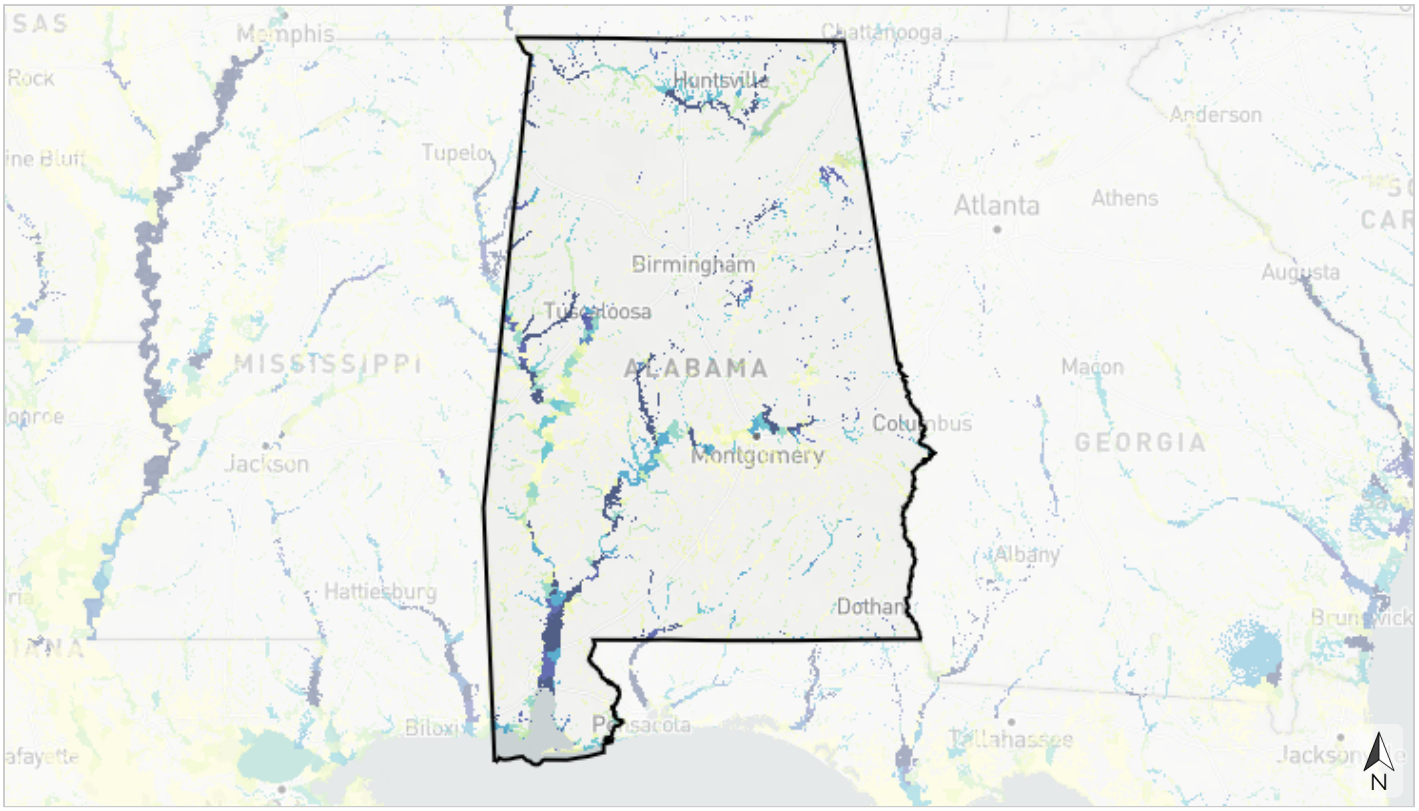
	Indicator Values	Acres	Percent of Area	
↑ High	Presence of Gulf sturgeon	131,857	0.4%	
	Presence of Alabama shad, American shad, or striped bass	202	<0.1%	↑ In good condition
↓ Low	Not identified as Gulf migratory fish habitat (east of the Mississippi River)	22,685,308	67.6%	↓ Not in good condition
	Area not evaluated for this indicator	*10,731,441*	*32.0%*	
	Total area	**33,548,808**	**100%**	

To learn more and explore the GIS data, view this indicator in the SECAS Atlas.

Freshwater

Imperiled aquatic species

This indicator measures the number of aquatic animal Regional Species of Greatest Conservation Need (RSGCN) observed within each 12-digit HUC subwatershed, including fish, mussels, snails, crayfish, and amphibians. It captures patterns of rare and endemic aquatic species diversity. RSGCN are regional priority species derived from the list of SGCN identified in Southeast State Wildlife Action Plans as most in need of need of conservation action. RSGCN were chosen based on consistent criteria, such as level of conservation concern, regional stewardship responsibility, and ecological significance. This indicator originates from state Natural Heritage Program data collected by the Southeast Aquatic Resources Partnership and applies to the Environmental Protection Agency's estimated floodplain, which spatially defines areas estimated to be inundated by a 100-year flood (also known as the 1% annual chance flood).



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Number of aquatic animal Regional Species of Greatest Conservation Need (RSGCN) observed

- 8+ species
- 7 species
- 6 species
- 5 species
- 4 species
- 3 species
- 2 species
- 1 species
- 0 species
- Not identified as a floodplain

Table 23: Indicator values for imperiled aquatic species within Alabama. A good condition threshold is not yet defined for this indicator.

	Indicator Values: Number of aquatic animal Regional Species of Greatest Conservation Need (RSGCN) observed	Acres	Percent of Area
↑ High	8+ species	677,348	2.0%
	7 species	227,043	0.7%
	6 species	88,033	0.3%
	5 species	361,183	1.1%
	4 species	346,554	1.0%
	3 species	493,337	1.5%
	2 species	659,623	2.0%
	1 species	979,981	2.9%
	0 species	1,261,981	3.8%
↓ Low	Not identified as a floodplain	27,958,013	83.3%
	Area not evaluated for this indicator	*495,713*	*1.5%*
	Total area	**33,548,808**	**100%**

To learn more and explore the GIS data, view this indicator in the SECAS Atlas.

Freshwater

Lakes & reservoirs

This indicator assesses the condition of lakes and reservoirs based on the amount of natural landcover within the upstream watershed. Higher scores go to lakes and reservoirs with less surrounding urban and agricultural development (including intensive forest management for timber production), which negatively impact drinking water quality and quantity and fish habitat. This indicator uses waterbody and watershed data from the LAGOS-LOCUS dataset, as well as landcover from the National Land Cover Database and LANDFIRE.



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- Lake or reservoir with low disturbance (0-25%) in upstream watershed
- Lake or reservoir with medium disturbance (>25-60%) in upstream watershed
- Lake or reservoir with high disturbance (>60%) in upstream watershed
- Not identified as a lake or reservoir

Table 24: Indicator values for lakes & reservoirs within Alabama. Good condition thresholds reflect the range of indicator values that occur in healthy, functioning ecosystems.

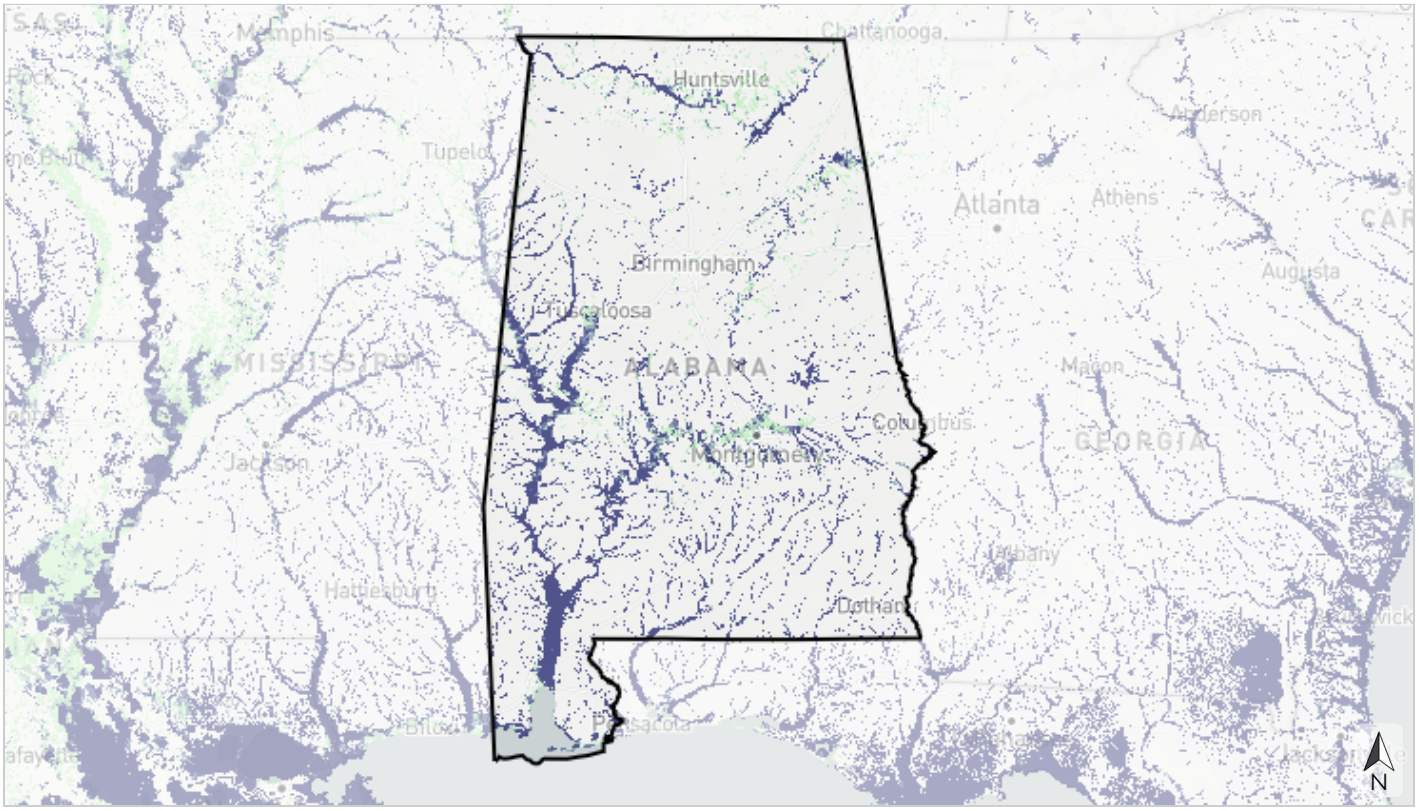
	Indicator Values	Acres	Percent of Area	
↑ High	Lake or reservoir with low disturbance (0-25%) in upstream watershed	22,725	<0.1%	↑ In good condition
	Lake or reservoir with medium disturbance (>25-60%) in upstream watershed	469,810	1.4%	↓ Not in good condition
	Lake or reservoir with high disturbance (>60%) in upstream watershed	53,623	0.2%	
↓ Low	Not identified as a lake or reservoir	33,002,253	98.4%	
	Area not evaluated for this indicator	*397*	*<0.1%*	
	Total area	**33,548,808**	**100%**	

To learn more and explore the GIS data, view this indicator in the SECAS Atlas.

Freshwater

Natural landcover in floodplains

This indicator measures the amount of natural landcover in the estimated floodplain of rivers and streams within each catchment. It assesses the stream channel and its surrounding riparian buffer, measuring the percent of unaltered habitat like forests, wetlands, or open water (rather than agriculture or development). Intact vegetated buffers within the floodplain of rivers and streams provide aquatic habitat, improve water quality, reduce erosion and flooding, recharge groundwater, and more. This indicator originates from the National Land Cover Database and applies to the Environmental Protection Agency's estimated floodplain, which spatially defines areas estimated to be inundated by a 100-year flood (also known as the 1% annual chance flood).



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Percent natural landcover within the estimated floodplain, by catchment

- >90% natural landcover
- >80-90% natural landcover
- >70-80% natural landcover
- >60-70% natural landcover
- ≤60% natural landcover
- Not identified as a floodplain

Table 25: Indicator values for natural landcover in floodplains within Alabama. Good condition thresholds reflect the range of indicator values that occur in healthy, functioning ecosystems.

	Indicator Values: Percent natural landcover within the estimated floodplain, by catchment	Acres	Percent of Area	
↑ High	>90% natural landcover	3,166,518	9.4%	
	>80-90% natural landcover	568,975	1.7%	↑ In good condition
	>70-80% natural landcover	338,669	1.0%	↓ Not in good condition
	>60-70% natural landcover	263,950	0.8%	
	≤60% natural landcover	756,969	2.3%	
↓ Low	Not identified as a floodplain	27,957,939	83.3%	
	Area not evaluated for this indicator	*495,787*	*1.5%*	
	Total area	**33,548,808**	**100%**	

To learn more and explore the GIS data, view this indicator in the SECAS Atlas.

Freshwater

Network complexity

This indicator depicts the number of connected stream size classes in a river network between dams or waterfalls. River networks with a variety of connected stream classes help retain aquatic biodiversity in a changing climate by allowing species to access climate refugia and move between habitats. This indicator originates from the Southeast Aquatic Resources Partnership and applies to the Environmental Protection Agency's estimated floodplain, which spatially defines areas estimated to be inundated by a 100-year flood (also known as the 1% annual chance flood).



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Number of connected stream size classes

- 7 size classes
- 6 size classes
- 5 size classes
- 4 size classes
- 3 size classes
- 2 size classes
- 1 size class
- Not identified as a floodplain

Table 26: Indicator values for network complexity within Alabama. Good condition thresholds reflect the range of indicator values that occur in healthy, functioning ecosystems.

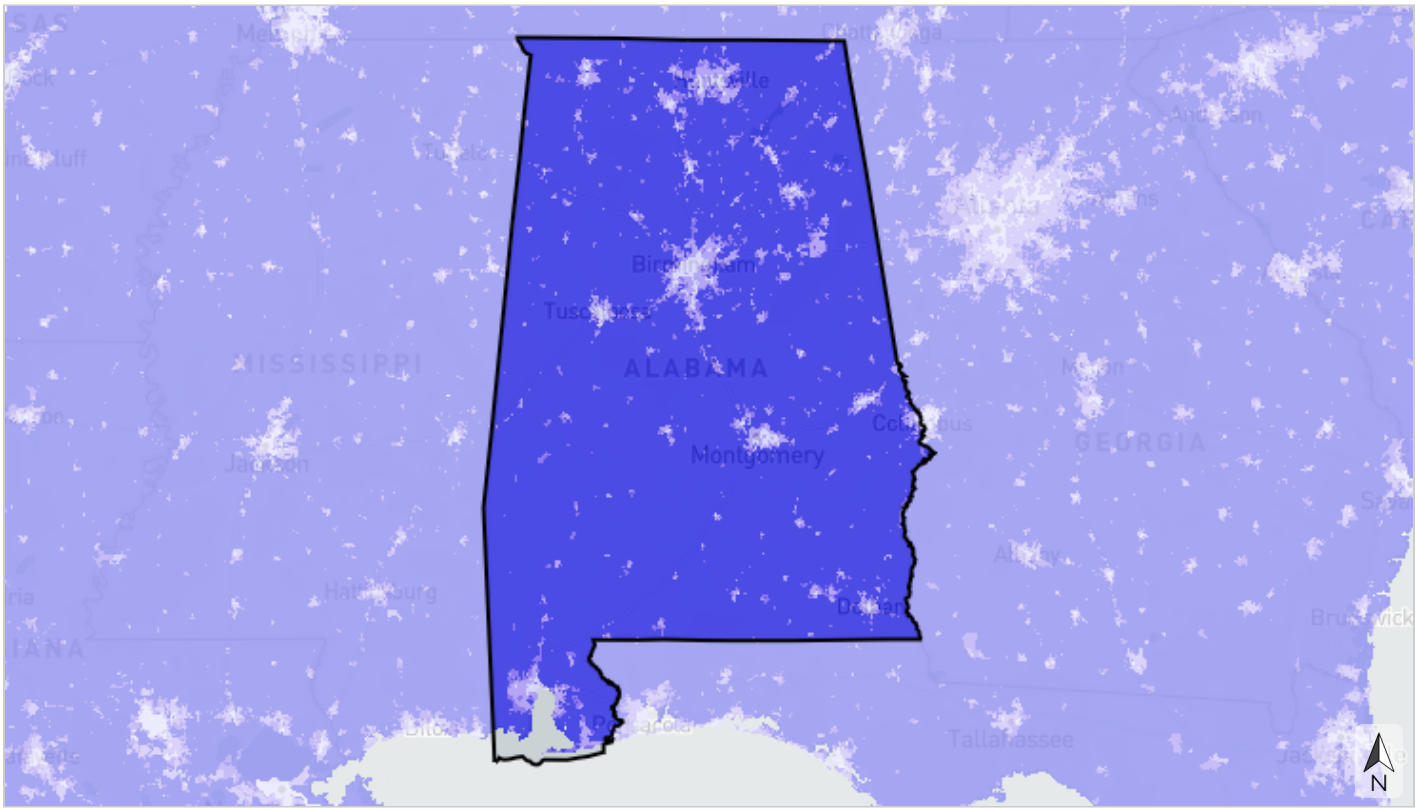
	Indicator Values: Number of connected stream size classes	Acres	Percent of Area	
↑ High	7 size classes	682,132	2.0%	
	6 size classes	1,130,726	3.4%	
	5 size classes	1,984,676	5.9%	
	4 size classes	504,852	1.5%	↑ In good condition
	3 size classes	328,831	1.0%	↓ Not in good condition
	2 size classes	280,494	0.8%	
	1 size class	178,566	0.5%	
↓ Low	Not identified as a floodplain	27,957,581	83.3%	
	Area not evaluated for this indicator	*500,949*	*1.5%*	
	Total area	**33,548,808**	**100%**	

To learn more and explore the GIS data, view this indicator in the SECAS Atlas.

Freshwater

Permeable surface

This indicator measures the average percent of non-impervious cover within each catchment. High levels of impervious surface degrade water quality and alter freshwater flow, impacting both aquatic species communities and ecosystem services for people, like the availability of clean drinking water. This indicator originates from the National Land Cover Database.



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Percent of catchment permeable

- >95% permeable (likely high water quality and supporting most sensitive aquatic species)
- >90-95% permeable (likely declining water quality and supporting most aquatic species)
- >70-90% permeable (likely degraded water quality and not supporting many aquatic species)
- ≤70% permeable (likely degraded instream flow, water quality, and aquatic species communities)

Table 27: Indicator values for permeable surface within Alabama. Good condition thresholds reflect the range of indicator values that occur in healthy, functioning ecosystems.

	Indicator Values: Percent of catchment permeable	Acres	Percent of Area	
↑ High	>95% permeable (likely high water quality and supporting most sensitive aquatic species)	30,403,332	90.6%	↑ In good condition
	>90-95% permeable (likely declining water quality and supporting most aquatic species)	1,121,637	3.3%	↓ Not in good condition
	>70-90% permeable (likely degraded water quality and not supporting many aquatic species)	1,236,611	3.7%	
↓ Low	≤70% permeable (likely degraded instream flow, water quality, and aquatic species communities)	291,515	0.9%	
	Area not evaluated for this indicator	*495,713*	*1.5%*	
	Total area	**33,548,808**	**100%**	

To learn more and explore the GIS data, view this indicator in the SECAS Atlas.

Coastal & marine

Coastal shoreline condition

This indicator assesses shoreline condition based on the presence of hardened structures like jetties, groins, and riprap, as well as other human development. By restricting the natural movement of sediment, shoreline armoring increases erosion, prevents the inland migration of coastal ecosystems in response to sea level rise, and degrades habitat for birds, sea turtles, fish, plants, and other species both on and offshore. Natural shorelines in harder-to-develop coastal areas receive the highest shoreline condition scores, while hardened shorelines receive the lowest scores. This indicator originates from the National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration's Environmental Sensitivity Index dataset.



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- Natural and harder to develop
- Natural
- Partially armored and harder to develop
- Partially armored
- Armored

Table 28: Indicator values for coastal shoreline condition within Alabama. Good condition thresholds reflect the range of indicator values that occur in healthy, functioning ecosystems.

	Indicator Values	Acres	Percent of Area	
↑ High	Natural and harder to develop	1,673	<0.1%	
	Natural	17,564	<0.1%	↑ In good condition
	Partially armored and harder to develop	16	<0.1%	↓ Not in good condition
	Partially armored	829	<0.1%	
↓ Low	Armored	2,256	<0.1%	
	Area not evaluated for this indicator	*33,526,471*	*99.9%*	
	Total area	**33,548,808**	**100%**	

To learn more and explore the GIS data, view this indicator in the SECAS Atlas.

Coastal & marine

Estuarine coastal condition

This indicator combines measures of water quality, sediment quality, contaminants in fish tissue, and benthic community condition to create an overall index of coastal estuarine condition. Estuaries serve as important nursery habitat for wildlife, including many species of fish and shellfish eaten as seafood. They also improve water quality by filtering out sediments and pollutants, provide recreational opportunities, and support coastal economies. This indicator originates from the Environmental Protection Agency's National Coastal Condition Assessment data.



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- Good
- Fair to good
- Fair
- Poor to fair
- Poor
- Shallow estuary not assessed for condition

Table 29: Indicator values for estuarine coastal condition within Alabama. Good condition thresholds reflect the range of indicator values that occur in healthy, functioning ecosystems.

	Indicator Values	Acres	Percent of Area	
↑ High	Good	7,174	<0.1%	
	Fair to good	190,145	0.6%	↑ In good condition
	Fair	210,039	0.6%	↓ Not in good condition
	Poor to fair	33	<0.1%	
	Poor	0.22	<0.1%	
↓ Low	Shallow estuary not assessed for condition	36,246	0.1%	
	Area not evaluated for this indicator	*33,105,170*	*98.7%*	
	Total area	**33,548,808**	**100%**	

To learn more and explore the GIS data, view this indicator in the SECAS Atlas.

Coastal & marine

Gulf coral & hardbottom

This indicator predicts the presence of coral and hardbottom in the Gulf of America based on direct observations, acoustic surveys, and known locations of artificial reefs and shipwrecks. Hardbottom provides an anchor for important seafloor habitats such as deep-sea corals, plants, and sponges, providing valuable structure that supports a wide range of invertebrate and fish species. Hardbottom is also sometimes associated with diverse chemosynthetic communities supported by micro-organisms that feed off of hydrocarbon seeps. This indicator combines data from multiple sources, including Bureau of Ocean Energy Management seismic water bottom anomalies, usSEABED sediment data, several National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration datasets, various state layers, and more.



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- Confirmed hardbottom-associated species (e.g., corals, sponges, patch reef, chemosynthetic communities)
- Confirmed natural hardbottom
- Artificial reefs
- Shipwrecks
- Probable natural hardbottom (fine resolution)
- Rock (coarse resolution)
- Gravel (coarse resolution)
- Not identified as hardbottom

Table 30: Indicator values for Gulf coral & hardbottom within Alabama. A good condition threshold is not yet defined for this indicator.

	Indicator Values	Acres	Percent of Area
↑ High	Confirmed hardbottom-associated species (e.g., corals, sponges, patch reef, chemosynthetic communities)	17	<0.1%
	Confirmed natural hardbottom	0	0%
	Artificial reefs	1,869	<0.1%
	Shipwrecks	1,245	<0.1%
	Probable natural hardbottom (fine resolution)	0	0%
	Rock (coarse resolution)	17,816	<0.1%
	Gravel (coarse resolution)	1,055	<0.1%
↓ Low	Not identified as hardbottom	678,165	2.0%
	Area not evaluated for this indicator	*32,848,642*	*97.9%*
	Total area	**33,548,808**	**100%**

To learn more and explore the GIS data, view this indicator in the SECAS Atlas.

Coastal & marine

Gulf marine birds

This indicator identifies important areas in the Gulf of America for birds that feed exclusively or mainly at sea. It uses habitat suitability models for 24 species of marine birds (black-capped petrel, black tern, Bonaparte's gull, brown booby, brown noddy, brown pelican, bridled tern, band-rumped storm-petrel, Cory's shearwater, common loon, common tern, great shearwater, herring gull, laughing gull, masked booby, magnificent frigatebird, northern gannet, parasitic jaeger, royal tern, sandwich tern, sargasso shearwater, sooty tern, Wilson's storm-petrel, and pomarine jaeger) based on sightings from vessel-based and aerial surveys. This indicator originates from the Gulf of Mexico Marine Assessment Program for Protected Species (GoMMAPPS) seabird models.



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- High marine bird richness (9-16 of 24 modeled species)
- Medium marine bird richness (6-8 of 24 modeled species)
- Low marine bird richness (0-5 of 24 modeled species)

Table 31: Indicator values for Gulf marine birds within Alabama. A good condition threshold is not yet defined for this indicator.

	Indicator Values	Acres	Percent of Area
↑ High	High marine bird richness (9-16 of 24 modeled species)	28,901	<0.1%
	Medium marine bird richness (6-8 of 24 modeled species)	33,991	0.1%
↓ Low	Low marine bird richness (0-5 of 24 modeled species)	300,707	0.9%
	Area not evaluated for this indicator	*33,185,209*	*98.9%*
	Total area	**33,548,808**	**100%**

To learn more and explore the GIS data, view this indicator in the SECAS Atlas.

Coastal & marine

Gulf marine mammals

This indicator identifies important areas in the Gulf of America for dolphins and whales. It incorporates monthly density predictions for 13 marine mammal species or species groups (Atlantic spotted dolphin, beaked whales, blackfish [which includes killer whale, melon-headed whale, false killer whale, pygmy killer whale], bottlenose dolphin, Bryde's whale, clymene dolphin, pantropical spotted dolphin, pilot whales, pygmy/dwarf sperm whales, Rice's whale, Risso's dolphin, sperm whale, spinner dolphin) based on sightings from boat-based and aerial surveys and data on oceanographic conditions. It uses marine mammal models developed by the National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration as part of the Gulf of Mexico Marine Assessment Program for Protected Species (GoMMAPPS).



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Percentile of importance for marine mammal index species (across larger analysis area)

- >90th percentile
- >80th-90th percentile
- >70th-80th percentile
- >60th-70th percentile
- >50th-60th percentile
- >40th-50th percentile
- >30th-40th percentile
- >20th-30th percentile
- >10th-20th percentile
- ≤10th percentile
- Land

Table 32: Indicator values for Gulf marine mammals within Alabama. A good condition threshold is not yet defined for this indicator.

	Indicator Values: Percentile of importance for marine mammal index species (across larger analysis area)	Acres	Percent of Area
↑ High	>90th percentile	0	0%
	>80th-90th percentile	4,445	<0.1%
	>70th-80th percentile	6,993	<0.1%
	>60th-70th percentile	5,855	<0.1%
	>50th-60th percentile	34,745	0.1%
	>40th-50th percentile	17,408	<0.1%
	>30th-40th percentile	13,654	<0.1%
	>20th-30th percentile	0	0%
	>10th-20th percentile	0	0%
	≤10th percentile	390,916	1.2%
↓ Low	Land	3,471	<0.1%
	Area not evaluated for this indicator	*33,071,322*	*98.6%*
	Total area	**33,548,808**	**100%**

To learn more and explore the GIS data, view this indicator in the SECAS Atlas.

Coastal & marine

Gulf sea turtles

This indicator identifies important areas in the Gulf of America for sea turtles. It incorporates monthly density predictions for four species (green, Kemp's ridley, leatherback, and loggerhead sea turtles) based on sightings from boat-based and aerial surveys and data on oceanographic conditions. It uses sea turtle models developed by the National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration as part of the Gulf of Mexico Marine Assessment Program for Protected Species (GoMMAPPS).



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Percentile of importance for sea turtle index species (across larger analysis area)

- >90th percentile
- >80th-90th percentile
- >70th-80th percentile
- >65th-70th percentile
- ≤65th percentile
- Land

Table 33: Indicator values for Gulf sea turtles within Alabama. A good condition threshold is not yet defined for this indicator.

	Indicator Values: Percentile of importance for sea turtle index species (across larger analysis area)	Acres	Percent of Area
↑ High	>90th percentile	41,124	0.1%
	>80th-90th percentile	44,711	0.1%
	>70th-80th percentile	0	0%
	>65th-70th percentile	0	0%
	≤65th percentile	423,970	1.3%
↓ Low	Land	231,006	0.7%
	Area not evaluated for this indicator	*32,807,997*	*97.8%*
	Total area	**33,548,808**	**100%**

To learn more and explore the GIS data, view this indicator in the SECAS Atlas.

Coastal & marine

Island habitat

This indicator represents important habitat for coastal island-dependent species across the Southeast. Because the isolation of islands can make them ecologically unique and protect them from disturbance and mainland predators, they often serve as important habitat for many species of mammals, plants, and insects, as well as breeding coastal birds and sea turtles. The highest scores go to island critical habitat for six threatened and endangered animal and plant species: piping plover, loggerhead sea turtle, Cape Sable thoroughwort, Florida semaphore cactus, silver rice rat, and Bartram's hairstreak butterfly. This indicator uses U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service critical habitat data and island boundaries from the U.S. Geological Survey and Esri.



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- Island critical habitat for any of six threatened and endangered species (piping plover, loggerhead sea turtle, Cape Sable thoroughwort, Florida semaphore cactus, silver rice rat, or Bartram's hairstreak butterfly)
- Other island area
- Not a coastal island

Table 34: Indicator values for island habitat within Alabama. A good condition threshold is not yet defined for this indicator.

	Indicator Values	Acres	Percent of Area
↑ High	Island critical habitat for any of six threatened and endangered species (piping plover, loggerhead sea turtle, Cape Sable thoroughwort, Florida semaphore cactus, silver rice rat, or Bartram's hairstreak butterfly)	2,223	<0.1%
	Other island area	32,054	<0.1%
↓ Low	Not a coastal island	2,319,153	6.9%
	Area not evaluated for this indicator	*31,195,378*	*93.0%*
	Total area	**33,548,808**	**100%**

To learn more and explore the GIS data, view this indicator in the SECAS Atlas.

Coastal & marine

Resilient coastal sites

This indicator depicts the capacity of coastal habitats to migrate to adjacent lowlands in order to sustain biodiversity and natural services under increasing inundation from sea level rise. It is based on the physical and condition characteristics of current tidal complexes, their predicted migration space, and surrounding buffer areas. These characteristics include marsh complex size, shared edge with migration space, sediment balance, water quality, natural landcover, landform diversity, and more. This indicator originates from The Nature Conservancy's Resilient Coastal Sites project.



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- Most resilient
- More resilient
- Slightly more resilient
- Average/median resilience
- Slightly less resilient
- Less resilient
- Least resilient
- Sea level rise area

Table 35: Indicator values for resilient coastal sites within Alabama. A good condition threshold is not yet defined for this indicator.

	Indicator Values	Acres	Percent of Area
↑ High	Most resilient	0	0%
	More resilient	187,413	0.6%
	Slightly more resilient	39,830	0.1%
	Average/median resilience	24,222	<0.1%
	Slightly less resilient	771	<0.1%
	Less resilient	868	<0.1%
	Least resilient	407	<0.1%
↓ Low	Sea level rise area	21,773	<0.1%
	Area not evaluated for this indicator	*33,273,523*	*99.2%*
	Total area	**33,548,808**	**100%**

To learn more and explore the GIS data, view this indicator in the SECAS Atlas.

Coastal & marine

Seagrass

This indicator represents the presence of seagrass in the Atlantic Ocean and Gulf of America. Seagrasses provide food and habitat for a range of marine and estuarine wildlife, including fish, sea turtles, shrimp, crabs, oysters, and more. They also produce oxygen, filter water, control erosion, and buffer storms. Seagrasses serve as an important indicator of the overall health of coastal ecosystems because they are sensitive to water quality and require sufficiently clear water for sunlight to penetrate. This indicator originates from the National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration's Marine Cadastre.



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Seagrass present

Table 36: Indicator values for seagrass within Alabama. A good condition threshold is not yet defined for this indicator.

	Indicator Values	Acres	Percent of Area
↑ High	Seagrass present	9,312	<0.1%
	Area not evaluated for this indicator	*33,539,496*	*100.0%*
	Total area	**33,548,808**	**100%**

To learn more and explore the GIS data, view this indicator in the SECAS Atlas.

Coastal & marine

Stable coastal wetlands

This indicator uses remote sensing to calculate the unvegetated-vegetated ratio of tidal wetlands, which compares how much of a wetland is not covered by plants (e.g., sediment, rocks, open water) to how much is covered by plants. Marshes that maintain a higher proportion of vegetation tend to be more stable and resilient to threats like sea level rise, erosion, and coastal development. This ratio, and how it changes over time, is a good surrogate for salt marsh degradation processes like sediment loss and conversion to open water. This indicator originates from a U.S. Geological Survey project on an unvegetated to vegetated ratio for coastal wetlands.



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- Stable coastal wetlands
- Other coastal wetlands
- Not identified as coastal wetlands

Table 37: Indicator values for stable coastal wetlands within Alabama. Good condition thresholds reflect the range of indicator values that occur in healthy, functioning ecosystems.

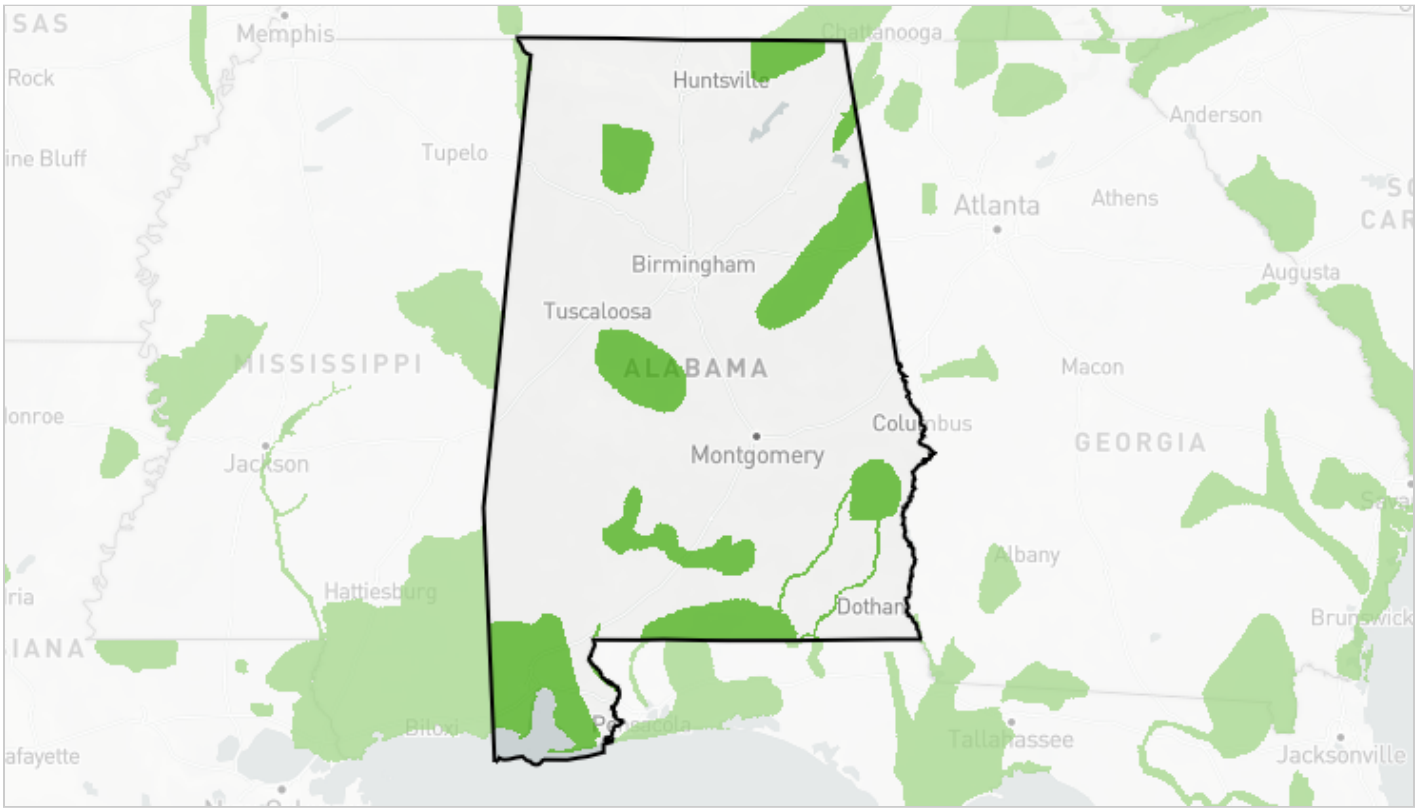
	Indicator Values	Acres	Percent of Area	
↑ High	Stable coastal wetlands	41,628	0.1%	↑ In good condition
	Other coastal wetlands	13,063	<0.1%	↓ Not in good condition
↓ Low	Not identified as coastal wetlands	825,117	2.5%	
	Area not evaluated for this indicator	*32,669,000*	*97.4%*	
	Total area	**33,548,808**	**100%**	

To learn more and explore the GIS data, view this indicator in the SECAS Atlas.

More Information

Priority Amphibian and Reptile Conservation Areas

Priority Amphibian and Reptile Conservation Areas (PARCAs) are an expert-driven, nonregulatory designation that includes places capable of supporting viable amphibian and reptile populations, places occupied by rare or imperiled species, and places rich in biodiversity or species unique to that geographic area. Reptiles and amphibians are a critical part of the Southeast region's rich biodiversity and many populations are declining in the face of threats like habitat loss, invasive species, and climate change. The PARCA dataset is maintained by the Amphibian and Reptile Conservancy and does not yet include Virginia or Kentucky.





Priority Amphibian and Reptile Conservation Area (PARCA)

Not a PARCA (excluding Kentucky and Virginia)

Table 38: Extent of Priority Amphibian and Reptile Conservation Areas within Alabama.

Priority Amphibian and Reptile Conservation Areas status	Acres	Percent of Area
Priority Amphibian and Reptile Conservation Area (PARCA)	5,532,781	16.5%
Not a PARCA (excluding Kentucky and Virginia)	28,008,797	83.5%
Total area	**33,548,808**	**100%**

Priority Amphibian and Reptile Conservation Areas at this location:

Alabama Red Hills
The Red Hills of Alabama occur between the Conecuh and Alabama Rivers and are home to Alabama's state amphibian, the federally threatened Red Hills salamander. Of its remaining habitat, more than 60% is owned by private paper mills that practice clearcut logging. It also faces threats from invasive species and poor water quality. More research and conservation action is needed to ensure the longevity of this species, as well as the other at-risk species that occupy the Red Hills.

Bankhead
Known as the "land of a thousand waterfalls" and found at the southern tip of the Cumberland Plateau, Bankhead is one of the most important sites in the country for many endemic and imperiled species that face threats from stream barriers, coal mining, siltation runoff, development, and recreation in the Bankhead National Forest, which makes up the majority of this PARCA. Efforts are currently in progress to address issues of stream connectivity and water quality by removing or retrofitting low-head dams and culverts to restore the genetic health of fragmented aquatic species. These efforts are critical for two federally listed species in the PARCA, the Black Warrior waterdog (endangered) and flattened musk turtle (threatened).

Choctawhatchee Pea North
The Choctawhatchee Pea North PARCA runs between the Fall Line Hills and the Conecuh PARCAs and is threatened by watershed pollution, sedimentation, and loss of connectivity. This PARCA sufferers from too few protections and regulations. It was selected to protect the freshwater turtle species that reside in these rivers, such as the Barbour's map turtle, as well as imperiled amphibians and reptiles that rely on its riparian areas as critical habitat, like the pine barrens tree frog and eastern hognose snake.

Choctawhatchee Pea South
Designed with freshwater turtles in mind, the Choctawhatchee Pea South PARCA includes the wildlands of the Choctawhatchee River Wildlife Management Area and the river's tributaries. The Choctawhatchee River's many turtle species are vulnerable to siltation, pollution, and degradation of nesting grounds, so protecting both the riverine and surrounding riparian areas is of the utmost importance. Other imperiled reptiles and amphibians, like king snakes and river frogs, also call this PARCA home.

Conecuh
Conecuh, along the southern Alabama border, is a highly important area for conservation in the core of the state's coastal plains. Longleaf pine forests have historically made this area important for the federally threatened gopher tortoise, which faces little protection outside of the Conecuh National Forest. Endangered reptiles also face pressure here from the loss of prey species like the eastern pocket gopher. Addressing recreation and poor fire management are top priorities to keep these habitats healthy for the numerous amphibians and reptiles here, including the eastern glass lizard and eastern box turtle.

Eglin Blackwater
Spanning from the Alabama border to the Gulf of Mexico, the Eglin Blackwater PARCA includes land within Blackwater State Forest, Yellow River Wildlife Management Area, and Eglin Air Force Base, where many of the remaining reticulated flatwoods salamanders can be found. The Eglin Blackwater PARCA is also home

to other imperiled species like the Florida bog frog and the pine barrens tree frog.

Fall Line Hills
The Fall Line Hills PARCA contains the headwaters of the Pea and Choctawhatchee Rivers, as well as an important transitional zone between the Chunnenuggee Ridge, eastern Red Hills, and Black Belt. It's a significant area for enabling wide-reaching conservation action plans to protect an important refuge for many reptiles and amphibians, including the eastern coachwhip and eastern tiger salamander.

Gulf Coast
The Gulf Coast PARCA spans the southern portion of Mississippi, encompassing a diverse landscape influenced by its proximity to the Gulf of Mexico. This region includes coastal flatwoods and marshes, upland longleaf pine forests, and expansive riverine systems, with notable features such as the Pascagoula River, renowned for its biodiversity. Habitats range from saltwater and freshwater marshes to fire-maintained longleaf pine forests, supporting species like the dusky gopher frog, Gulf salt marsh snake, and Mississippi diamondback terrapin. The confluence of these subregions, coupled with the area's history of fluctuating sea levels and sediment deposition, has sculpted a unique set of conditions conducive to supporting a wide range of plant and animal life, each with a distinct subset of species, threats, and conservation needs, underpinning its importance for conservation. Urban development, invasive species, and fire suppression are major threats that collaborative conservation efforts with national forests, national wildlife refuges, and educational institutions are crucial to address.

Jackson Mountains
Jackson Mountains is the most northeast PARCA in the state, and it's largely made up of oak-hickory habitats along the sandstone plateaus and ridges with carved limestone from the Cumberland Plateau. With its unique geology, this important habitat for species like the mole kingsnake and green salamander is connected to the large South Cumberland PARCA of Tennessee. Almost none of this large PARCA has federal or state land protection, making collaboration with private landowners critical.

Lake Seminole
The Lake Seminole PARCA is an extension of the Red Hills formation with clay-rich soil. It boasts mature longleaf pine savannas with diverse herbaceous ground cover, good structure from stump holes and tortoise burrows, and extensive open wetlands fed by springs. The longleaf pine communities and embedded isolated wetlands provide habitat for upland reptile species. The Lower Chattahoochee and Flint Rivers, as well as Spring Creek, support robust turtle populations, while seepages in the region harbor several salamander species.

Little River Canyon
The Little River Canyon offers a diverse ecosystem of forested uplands, waterfalls, canyon rims, pools, boulders, and sandstone cliffs to amphibians and reptiles in the Southern Appalachians, including the rare and elusive northern pine snake. The core area of this PARCA is protected along the Little River Canyon National Preserve. However, because wildlife species have no knowledge of map boundaries, they face threats from upstream water quality issues, private forestry operations, and recreation. For this reason, this PARCA is bordered upstream by Lookout/Pigeon Mountain PARCA in Georgia.

Lookout Pigeon Mountain
Part of the Cumberland Plateau, both Lookout and Pigeon Mountains rise sharply from the valley floor with steep sandstone cliff faces. Forests transition from dense mesic hardwoods to pines and fire-adapted oaks on top. The sandstone caprock forms a flat, broad ridge that occasionally traps water, creating ephemeral wetlands. This region boasts the highest salamander species richness in Georgia, including rare and endemic species.

Mann's Land
Named in honor of herpetologist Tom Mann, a longtime herpetologist in the region, the Mann's Land PARCA, located in east-central Mississippi, includes the Tombigbee National Forest and Black Prairie Wildlife Management Area. This PARCA features a mosaic of open prairies, chalk outcrops, and oak-hickory forests. The unique geology, including alkaline soils supporting prairie flora, provides habitats for species like the Webster's salamander, crawfish frog, and prairie kingsnake. Key threats are prairie conversion, invasive species like cogongrass, and incompatible forestry practices. Conservation efforts can be supported by partnerships with Mississippi State University, private landowners, and the Natural Resources Conservation Service (NRCS). Important research needs include mapping surface geology for salamanders and monitoring the effectiveness of prairie restoration efforts.

Mobile Bay
Alabama's largest PARCA, Mobile Bay, contains a largely developed metro area, and in a region of such high biodiversity, this has pushed many species to the brink of extirpation. This area is considered the world's center of turtle diversity, harboring beautiful species like the eastern chicken turtle, southern painted turtle, Alabama red-bellied turtle, and Mississippi diamondback terrapin. Often called "America's Amazon," it was the boyhood home of EO Wilson; his dream was that it would one day hold a national park to celebrate its amazing biodiversity. Undeveloped areas along the coast and inland swamps are key habitats for a large number of imperiled amphibian and reptile species that find refuge or breed here, including the Gulf Coast waterdog.

Oakmulgee
The Oakmulgee PARCA is a large tract of the Fall Line Hills, which separates the hard Piedmont rocks of the Appalachian Highlands from the softer rocks of the Atlantic Plain. Though predominantly hardwood, several islands of longleaf pine in the midst of intensive logging pressure make this an important refuge for amphibians and reptiles, including the southeastern five-lined skink and seepage salamander. The vegetation is similar to the Upper Coastal Plains, with steep slopes more reminiscent of the Appalachian Plateau. Oakmulgee National Forest encompasses a large portion of this PARCA.

Perdido River
The Perdido River flows through southern Alabama and was once dominated by longleaf pine; today human development, logging, and absence of fire has left only 4% remaining. These deep sands are home to many imperiled reptiles and amphibians that existed for millions of years in these longleaf pine forests, and with cooperative conservation measures, will hopefully live for a million more. A diversity of frog species inhabit the PARCA, including the Cope’s gray tree frog, barking tree frog, northern spring peeper, eastern narrowmouth toad, eastern spadefoot, and southern leopard frog.

South Cumberland
The South Cumberland PARCA occurs within the Southwestern Appalachians ecoregion and includes portions of the Southern Cumberland Plateau, Plateau Escarpment, and Sequatchie Valley. The Cumberland Plateau is diverse in habitat, ranging from predominantly acidic, well-drained soils where hardwood forests thrive to diverse boulder fields, rock outcrops, vertical rock faces, and cliffs along the Plateau Escarpment. The Sequatchie Valley is generally open, rolling terrain drained by the Sequatchie River with mixed oak-hickory, maple forest, pastureland, and cropland. The unique habitat diversity throughout this region includes species of conservation concern like the eastern pine snake. They are often associated with well-drained, sandy soils in pine or mixed pine-hardwood forests, which are common throughout this region. However, unsustainable timber management, urban encroachment, and persecution by humans are just some of the threats that have led to their decline.

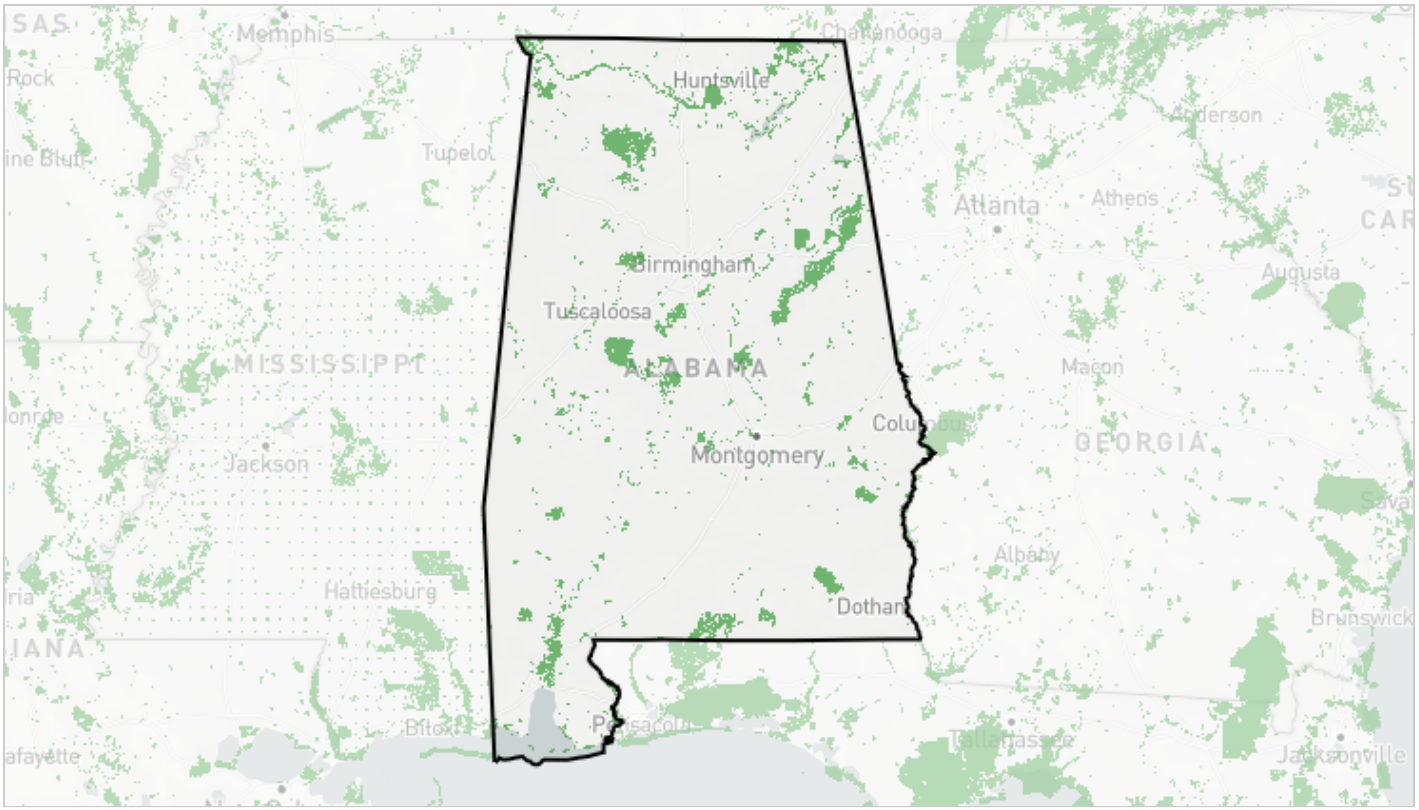
Talladega
Talladega is the second-largest PARCA in Alabama, with the Talladega National Forest running right through its core. Largely forested with deciduous trees, this site is important for reptiles and amphibians alike; however, it faces threats from fragmentation and human development, which creates more challenges for species already experiencing declines here, like the eastern slender glass lizard.

Tishomingo
The Tishomingo PARCA, located in the northeastern corner of Mississippi, is a unique ecological region due to its position at the southwestern reach of the Appalachian foothills. This area, part of the Cumberland Plateau, features rugged topography and distinct geological formations that merge into the Fall Line Hills and Blackbelt Prairie. The mixed hardwood and pine forests provide critical habitats for species like the eastern hellbender, green salamander, and northern pine snake. Threats to this region include non-compatible timber practices, river sedimentation, and agricultural runoff. Conservation efforts can be bolstered through partnerships with regional authorities, state parks, and local universities. Key research needs include expanded surveys for hellbenders and studies on the impacts of quarry operations.

Names and descriptions of public Priority Amphibian and Reptile Areas were provided by the Amphibian and Reptile Conservancy on August 30, 2024 and edited slightly for clarity and consistency.

Protected Areas

Protected areas include a variety of public lands owned or managed by federal, state, and local agencies and nonprofit organizations, as well as some private conservation lands and conservation easements. Protected areas are derived from the Protected Areas Database of the United States (PAD-US v4.1) and include Fee, Designation, Easement, Marine, and Proclamation (Dept. of Defense lands only) boundaries.



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Within a protected area

Not within a protected area

Table 39: Extent of protected areas within Alabama.

Protected area status	Acres	Percent of Area
Not within a protected area	31,458,636	93.8%
Within a protected area	2,090,173	6.2%
Total area	**33,548,808**	**100%**

Protected areas at this location:

- Talladega National Forest (USDA Forest Service; 394,709 acres)
- State-owned Submerged Lands (State of Alabama; 209,387 acres)
- William B. Bankhead National Forest (USDA Forest Service; 182,014 acres)
- Conecuh National Forest (USDA Forest Service; 85,123 acres)
- James D. Martin - Skyline Wildlife Management Area (60,494 acres)
- Fort Novosel AL (58,126 acres)
- Upper Delta Wildlife Management Area (Alabama Forever Wild Land Trust; 40,764 acres)
- Redstone Arsenal (38,180 acres)
- Mulberry Fork Wildlife Management Area (Alabama Forever Wild Land Trust; 33,457 acres)
- William R. Ireland, Sr. - Cahaba River Wildlife Management Area (Alabama Forever Wild Land Trust; 28,434 acres)
- Guntersville Reservoir Retained Land (25,886 acres)
- Sipsey Wilderness (25,851 acres)
- Freedom Hills Wildlife Management Area (Alabama Forever Wild Land Trust; 25,387 acres)
- Walter F. George Recreation Area (24,272 acres)
- Mobile-Tensaw Delta Wildlife Management Area (US Army Corps of Engineers; 22,468 acres)
- National Guard Clarke Range Complex - Fort McClellan (22,225 acres)
- Barbour Wildlife Management Area (ADCNR, Division of Wildlife and Freshwater Fisheries; 20,965 acres)
- Scotch Wildlife Management Area (Private Landowner; 19,754 acres)
- Coosa Wildlife Management Area (Private Landowners; 19,195 acres)
- W. L. Holland Wildlife Management Area (ADCNR, Division of Wildlife and Freshwater Fisheries; 19,188 acres)
- Walter F. George Lake (19,052 acres)
- Wheeler National Wildlife Refuge (18,851 acres)
- Frank W. and Rob M. Boykin Wildlife Management Area (Private Landowner; 18,614 acres)
- Sam R. Murphy Wildlife Management Area (Private Landowner; 17,821 acres)
- Wheeler Reservoir Retained Land (16,536 acres)
- ... and 1,794 more protected areas ...

Note: areas are listed based on name, ownership, and boundary information in the Protected Areas Database of the United States, which may include overlapping and duplicate areas. Only protected areas with at least 1 acre of overlap with this area are included in the list above.

Sea Level Rise

NOAA's sea level rise (SLR) inundation models represent areas likely to experience flooding at high tide based on each foot of SLR above current levels. Darker blue areas will experience flooding first, and at greater depth, compared to lighter blue areas. These models are not linked to a future timeframe; see the projections below. NOAA calculates the inundation footprint at "mean higher high water", or the average highest daily tide. The area covered in each SLR scenario includes areas projected to be inundated at lower levels. For example, the area inundated by 4 ft of SLR also includes areas inundated by 3 ft, 2 ft, 1 ft, and 0 ft of SLR (where 0 ft represents current levels).

To explore additional SLR information, please see NOAA's Sea Level Rise Viewer.



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Flooding extent by projected sea level rise (ft)

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Table 40: Extent of flooding by projected average highest daily tide due to sea level rise within Alabama. Values from the NOAA sea level rise inundation data.

Feet of sea level rise	Acres	Percent of Area
0 feet	551,149	1.6%
1 foot	608,017	1.8%
2 feet	655,482	2.0%
3 feet	685,453	2.0%
4 feet	705,527	2.1%
5 feet	722,488	2.2%
6 feet	739,980	2.2%
7 feet	757,460	2.3%
8 feet	774,512	2.3%
9 feet	795,782	2.4%
10 feet	814,255	2.4%
Not projected to be inundated by up to 10 feet	*3,717,750*	*11.1%*
Sea level rise is unlikely to be a threat (inland counties)	*29,016,803*	*86.5%*
Total area	**33,548,808**	**100%**

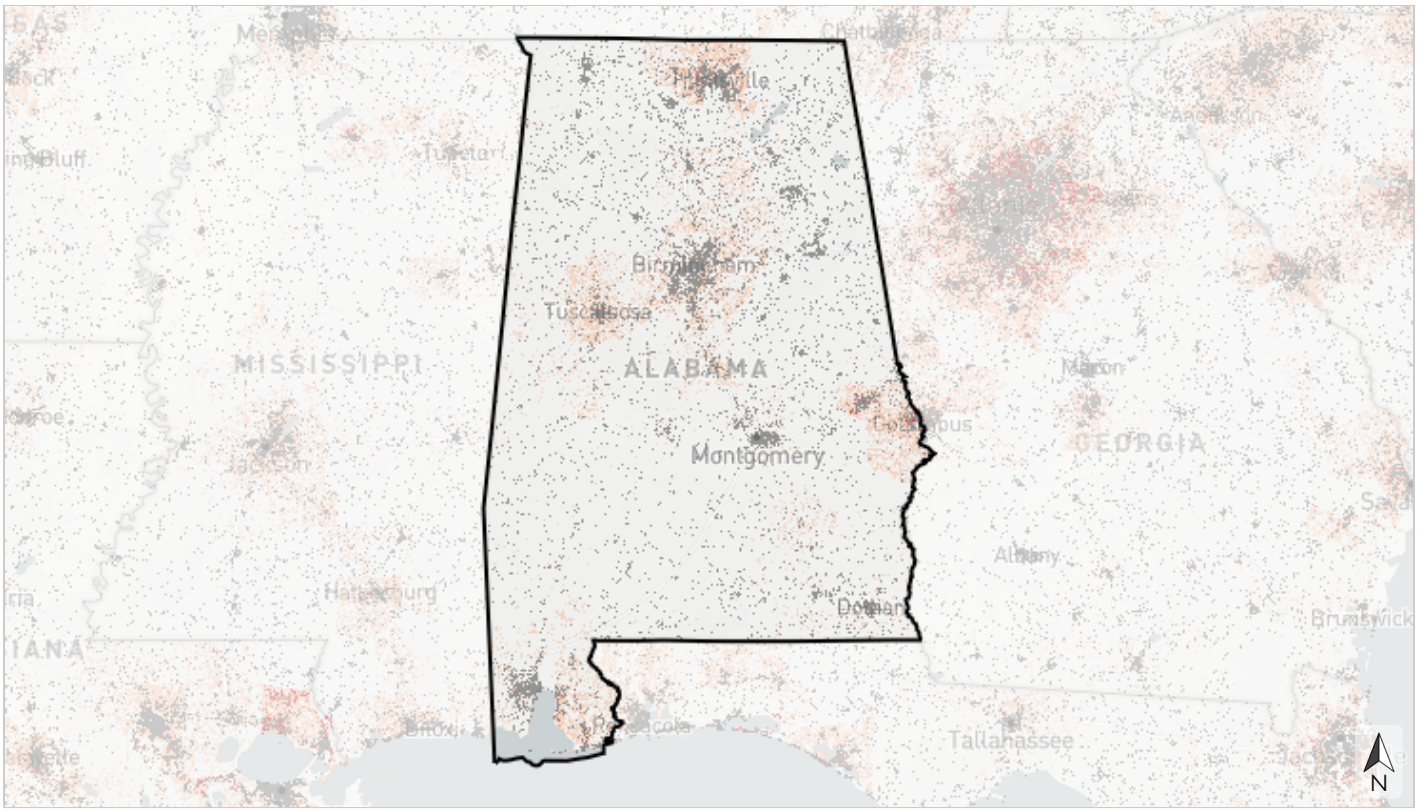
Table 41: Projected sea level rise by decade within Alabama. Values are based on area-weighted averages of decadal projections for 1-degree grid cells that overlap this area based on NOAA's 2022 Sea Level Rise Report. 2060 corresponds to the SECAS goal: a 10% or greater improvement in the health, function, and connectivity of Southeastern ecosystems by 2060.

SLR Scenario	2020 (ft)	2030 (ft)	2040 (ft)	2050 (ft)	2060 (ft)	2070 (ft)	2080 (ft)	2090 (ft)	2100 (ft)
Low	0.28	0.44	0.6	0.76	0.89	1	1.1	1.1	1.3
Intermediate-low	0.31	0.5	0.7	0.89	1.1	1.3	1.5	1.7	1.9
Intermediate	0.31	0.52	0.75	1	1.3	1.7	2.1	2.7	3.3
Intermediate-high	0.32	0.55	0.84	1.2	1.7	2.4	3.1	3.9	4.8
High	0.32	0.57	0.91	1.4	2.1	3	4.1	5.3	6.5

Urban Growth

The FUTURES urban growth model predicts the likelihood that an area will urbanize at every decade from 2020 to 2100. Developed areas from the 2021 National Landcover Database serve as the baseline for current urban areas. The model simulates landscape change based on trends in population growth, local development suitability factors, and an urban patch-growing algorithm. It considers environmental drivers like distance to floodplain, slope, and available infrastructure, and even socio-economic status. The probability of urbanization for each area reflects how many times it urbanized out of 50 model runs.

To explore maps for additional time periods, click here.



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Probability of urbanization by 2060

- Urban in 2021
- Very high likelihood of urbanization (>50% probability)
- High likelihood of urbanization (25 - 50% probability)
- Moderate likelihood of urbanization (2 - 25% probability)
- Not likely to urbanize

Table 42: Extent of projected urbanization by decade within Alabama. Values from FUTURES model projections for the contiguous United States developed by the Center for Geospatial Analytics, NC State University. 2060 corresponds to the SECAS goal: a 10% or greater improvement in the health, function, and connectivity of Southeastern ecosystems by 2060.

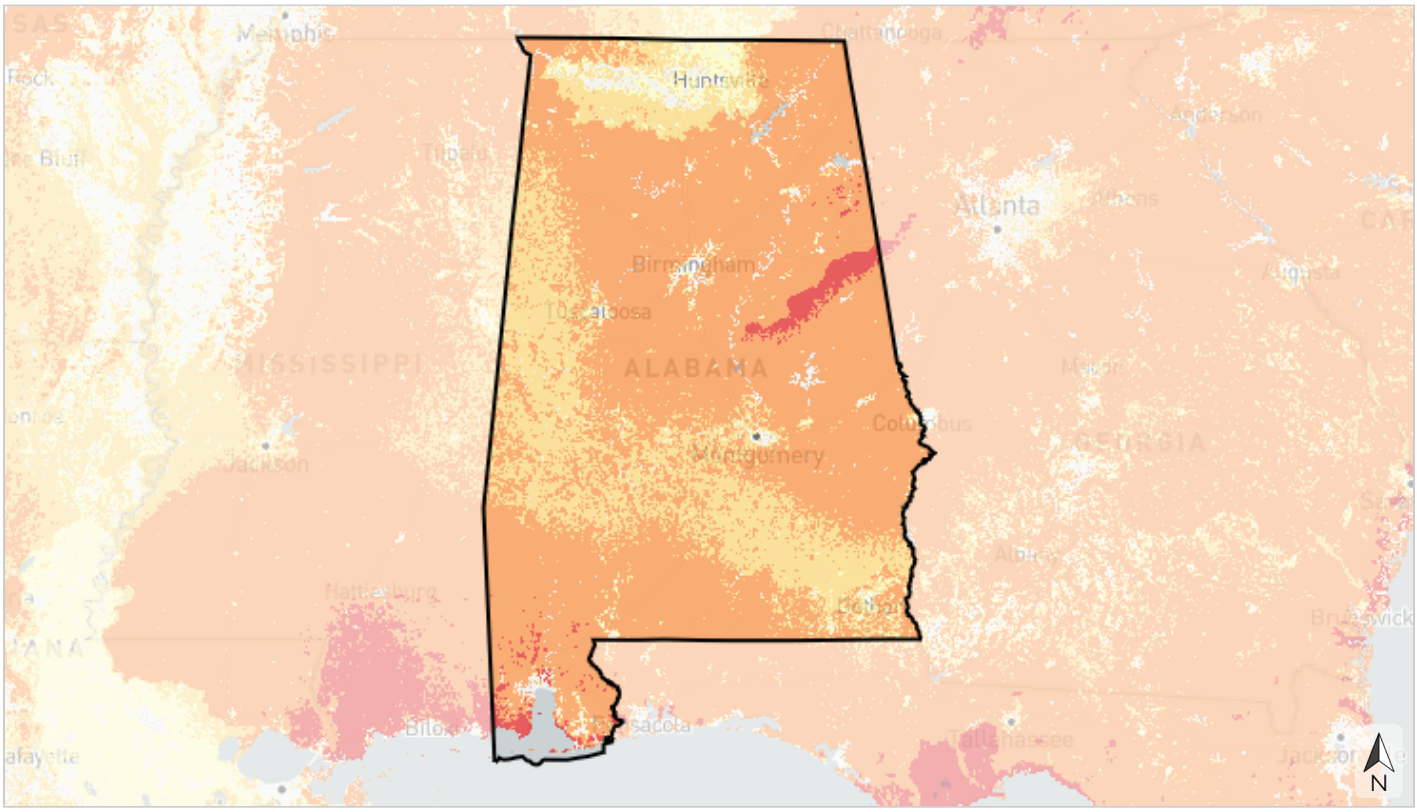
Decade	Acres	Percent of Area
Urban in 2021	2,659,986	7.9%
2030 projected extent	2,721,298	8.1%
2040 projected extent	2,749,996	8.2%
2050 projected extent	2,767,927	8.3%
2060 projected extent	2,783,901	8.3%
2070 projected extent	2,797,580	8.3%
2080 projected extent	2,808,092	8.4%
2090 projected extent	2,815,762	8.4%
2100 projected extent	2,820,299	8.4%
Not projected to urbanize by 2100	*30,721,278*	*91.6%*
No urbanization data available	*7,230*	*<0.1%*
Total area	**33,548,808**	**100%**

7.9% of this area is already urban in 2021, and an additional 7.4% has at least a moderate probability of urbanizing by 2060.

By 2060, the size of the urban footprint is projected to increase **4.7%** over 2021 levels.

Wildfire Likelihood

Wildfire likelihood data originate from the Wildfire Risk to Communities project developed by the U.S. Forest Service. This layer depicts the probability of wildfire burning in a specific location in any given year. Annual burn probabilities in the United States range from 0-14%, but do not exceed 8% in the Southeast. Wildfire likelihood is based on fire behavior modeling across thousands of simulations of possible fire seasons. In each simulation, factors contributing to the probability of a fire occurring (such as weather, topography, and ignitions) vary based on patterns derived from observations in recent decades. Wildfire likelihood is not predictive and does not reflect any forecasted future weather or fire danger conditions. It also does not say anything about the intensity of fire if it occurs. To explore additional wildfire risk information, please see the [Wildfire Risk to Communities] website.



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Wildfire likelihood (annual burn probability)

- High
- Moderate-high
- Moderate
- Low-moderate
- Low
- Not predicted to experience wildfire

Table 43: Area in each wildfire probability category within Alabama. Values from the Wildire Risk To Communities project developed by the USDA Forest Service.

Wildfire likelihood (annual burn probability)	Acres	Percent of Area
Not predicted to experience wildfire (0% probability)	1,580,272	4.7%
Low (>0 - 0.01% probability)	1,010,380	3.0%
Low-moderate (>0.01 - 0.02154% probability)	911,715	2.7%
Low-moderate (>0.02154 - 0.04642% probability)	6,898,135	20.6%
Moderate (>0.04642 - 0.1% probability)	9,722,585	29.0%
Moderate (>0.1 - 0.21544% probability)	7,736,024	23.1%
Moderate (>0.21544 - 0.46416% probability)	5,034,900	15.0%
Moderate-high (>0.46416 - 1% probability)	608,528	1.8%
Moderate-high (>1 - 2.15443% probability)	38,975	0.1%
High (>2.15443 - 4.64159% probability)	0	0%
High (>4.64159% probability)	0	0%
No wildfire risk data available	*7,294*	*<0.1%*
Total area	**33,548,808**	**100%**